



STRENGTH THROUGH SYSTEMS

The Facility System **Install**

The owner's do-it-yourself field manual. Ten systems, every checklist, every script, every number — start to finish.

Turn a facility that runs on one person's memory into one that runs on documented standards every coach follows the same way. Read it once. Then work it, page by page, for fourteen weeks.

How to use this book

This is not a book about systems. It is the system, written out, with the blanks left in for you to fill. Everything in here is what gets installed in a paid Facility System Install. You are doing it yourself. That is entirely possible — it costs you time instead of money.

What this actually is

A **program** is what one coach runs. A **system** is what every coach runs the same way. Almost every private facility in the country has programs. Very few have systems. That gap is why your best coach leaving takes the program with him, why a new hire takes four months to become useful, why parents don't see what they're paying for, and why you can't leave the building.

This manual closes that gap in ten systems. Each one solves a named problem, produces a named artifact, and hands off to the next one. They are not ten separate projects. They are one machine with ten parts, and the order matters more than the speed.

What you need before page one

- ☐ **Your whole coaching staff in one room for three hours.** Not a video call. Not a summary email afterward. This is the single non-negotiable time cost in the entire install, and everything downstream is built on what comes out of that room.
- ☐ **Your real schedule** — every training slot, the athletes booked into each one, the coaches on the floor for each one, and the actual door-to-door minutes.
- ☐ **Your real roster** — every active family, what they pay, and which group each athlete belongs to.
- ☐ **A printer and a wall.** Almost everything in this book is meant to be posted, not filed. A standard in a drive folder is not installed.
- ☐ **Fourteen weeks.** You can compress it, but you cannot skip the sequence.

The five rules that govern the whole book

RULE 1

Written is not installed. A system is installed when every coach runs it every session without being reminded. Anything short of that is a document, and documents do not survive a busy Tuesday.

RULE 2

Observation, never conversation. Nothing in this book gets signed off because somebody says they do it. It gets signed off because you watched them do it on a live session and put a date next to it.

RULE 3

Order beats speed. Standards first, then flow, then proof, then everything that depends on proof. Installing the reporting layer before the standards layer produces accurate reports about a room with no standard in it.

RULE 4

Every number routes somewhere. A measurement that doesn't name the system it sends you to is a statistic. Every number in this book has a destination.

RULE 5

The owner is the bottleneck until he builds a second certifier. Any system where only you can approve things is a dependency with paperwork on it.

How to read the page furniture

ELEMENT	WHAT IT MEANS
Black box	A rule. Non-negotiable. If you break it, the system stops working the way it's described here.
Green box	A standard. The line you hold the facility to. These go on the wall.
Grey box	A common mistake, or a failure mode. Read these twice — most installs die here, not on the build.
Dashed box	A script. Say it close to word-for-word the first ten times. Improvise after that.
☐ Checklist	Physical action. Tick it when it is done on the floor, not when it is done in your head.

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Part 4	Zero Downtime Session Blueprint — constraint set, flow bands, block template, filler standard, dead time audit	Weeks 2–4
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Part 6	Data-to-Action Reporting — the data standard, testing cycle, change bands, the Proof Report	Weeks 4–8
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Part 10	The Owner Command Center — SAR dashboard, the 90-day certification, the owner's rhythm	Ongoing
Part 11	The 14-week install calendar — week by week, what to do and what to have finished	—
Part 12	Master checklist & failure modes — every box in the book in one place	—

The dependency map — why the order is what it is

THIS SYSTEM	CANNOT RUN WITHOUT	BECAUSE
Certification (Pt 1)	Nothing. Start here.	Everything else is a standard, and you cannot certify against standards that don't exist.
Core 4 (Pt 2)	The standards session	The prep is the first thing the whole staff runs identically. It's the easiest early proof the standard holds.
Exercise Selection (Pt 3)	Certification	A coach who can't be trusted to run what's written will override the program he's handed.
Zero Downtime (Pt 4)	Exercise Selection, Core 4	The block template has fixed slots for prep and a primary lift. Both have to exist first.
Capacity (Pt 5)	Zero Downtime, Certification	Capacity is set by supervision, and a coach only counts if he's certified.
Data-to-Action (Pt 6)	Certification, Zero Downtime	Data comes off the floor. If logging isn't a certified standard, the data is fiction.
ABIR (Pt 7)	Runs at day zero and every cycle	It brackets the install rather than sitting inside it — baseline before, re-score after.
Parent Trust (Pt 8)	Data-to-Action	The Proof Report is made of logged numbers. No logging, no proof, no price increase.
Return-to-Train (Pt 9)	Emergency plan posts day one regardless	It's the only piece whose absence is a liability rather than an inefficiency.
Command Center (Pt 10)	All of the above producing data	The dashboard reads the other nine. Build it last, read it forever.

THE MOST COMMON DIY MISTAKE

Owners start at Part 6 or Part 8, because reporting and parent communication are the parts they feel embarrassed about. Both are downstream of logging, and logging is downstream of certification. Start at Part 0 and Part 1 even though they feel the least urgent. Fourteen weeks from now they are the only reason any of the rest held.



PART 0 • WEEK 0

Baseline

You cannot prove a system worked if you never wrote down what the building looked like before it. Four measurements, one week, before you install anything.

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- 01 The Adoption Audit — six components, four levels
 - 02 The Continuity Check — the walk-out test
 - 03 The ABIR Baseline — putting a number on buy-in
 - 04 The Constraint Set — the six inputs everything else runs on

The Adoption Audit

This measures one thing: not whether a system exists, but whether every coach runs it every session. Run it before you install anything, and re-run it at 90 days against the same six components.

The six components

Every facility, regardless of size or sport, runs on these six. Score each one honestly. The single hardest part of this audit is scoring your own building at a 1 when you want it to be a 3.

COMPONENT	THE QUESTION	HOW TO ACTUALLY CHECK IT
01 Program Build	Does the program come from your constraints, or from a blank page every cycle?	Ask to see the 52-week calendar. Ask who wrote it and what happens when that person is out.
02 Assessment	Does the program prescribe weight, or does every athlete guess?	Ask for one athlete's working weights. Time how long it takes to produce them.
03 Floor Log	Do you know what actually got done, or only what was planned?	Pick last Tuesday. Ask what one group actually lifted.
04 Testing & Tracker	Can you show an athlete's change over the last six months?	Ask for one athlete's last two test dates side by side.
05 Attendance	Do you know who's in the room, or only who's on the roster?	Ask which athletes missed more than three sessions last month.
06 Reports	Can a parent see what they're paying for without you writing it by hand?	Ask for the last report a parent received. Ask how long it took to make.

The four levels

SCORE	LEVEL	WHAT IT MEANS
0	Absent	Doesn't exist in any form.
1	In a head	It happens, but only because one specific person does it. Nothing written. It leaves when they leave.
2	Not run	It's written down or sitting in software. The floor doesn't follow it. This is the adoption gap.
3	Installed	Written, and every coach runs it every session without being reminded.

THE DISTINCTION THAT MATTERS MOST

A 2 and a 1 look identical on a Tuesday and are completely different problems. A 1 needs writing. A 2 needs enforcement. **Buying more software fixes neither, and most facilities that feel broken are sitting at 2s.**

Score sheet

COMPONENT	0	1	2	3	HOURS/WEEK THIS COSTS YOU NOW
Program Build					
Assessment					
Floor Log					
Testing & Tracker					
Attendance					
Reports					
TOTAL			____ / 18		____ hrs/wk

Reading the score

TOTAL	VERDICT	WHAT IT MEANS AND WHAT YOU DO
0-6	No department	This is a room with equipment in it. The six parts don't exist or don't connect. Start at Part 1 and build in order — don't try to fix six things at once.
7-12	Partial	Pieces exist. Nothing feeds the next thing, so none of it compounds. Your job is connection, not creation.
13-17	Close	Most of it is installed. The named gaps are exactly what's costing you capacity and time. Fix the 2s first — they're the cheapest points on the board.
18	Installed	All six running. Re-run in 90 days and hold the line. Drift is the only enemy left.

FIX ORDER

Work the **2s first** — the system already exists and only needs to be run, which is the fastest win in the building. Then the **1s** — write down what lives in one person's head. Then the **0s** — build from zero. Never start with a 0 while a 2 is open.

The time-cost calculation

This is the number that pays for the install, and the number that will keep you going in week seven when it stops feeling exciting. Add up the hours per week those six components cost you right now. Compare it to what they cost when installed.

COMPONENT	HOURS/WK NOW	HOURS/WK INSTALLED
Program Build	_____	0.2
Assessment	_____	0.1
Floor Log	_____	0.2
Testing & Tracker	_____	0.2
Attendance	_____	0.1
Reports	_____	0.3
TOTAL	_____	1.1

Hours recovered per year = (now – 1.1) × 52 = _____

Most facilities that run this honestly land between 12 and 18 hours a week across the six, which is 570 to 880 hours a year. That is the actual size of the prize, and it is almost always larger than the owner expected.

The Continuity Check

The walk-out test. One question, asked twenty ways: if your best coach resigned on Friday afternoon, what walks out of the building with him?

Run this on the same visit as the Adoption Audit. It takes twenty minutes and it is the most uncomfortable twenty minutes of the install. Score each line **Yes** only if the answer exists in writing, in a place a second person can find it without asking anyone.

A • Program continuity

- ☐ The next four weeks of programming exist in writing for every group, and a second person can find them.
- ☐ The reason behind the current block — what it is developing and why now — is written down, not just the exercises.
- ☐ Someone other than the author can explain what each group is training toward this cycle.
- ☐ Substitution rules exist in writing, so a covering coach knows what he may and may not change.

B • Athlete continuity

- ☐ Every athlete's current working loads are recorded somewhere other than a coach's phone or memory.
- ☐ Every athlete's last two test dates are retrievable in under two minutes.
- ☐ Every athlete with a current limitation or restriction has it written down, with a review date.
- ☐ Attendance for the last 30 days is retrievable per athlete, not just per session.

C • Coach continuity

- ☐ A written standards document exists, and every coach on staff has signed the current version.
- ☐ Every coach has a certification record showing what he has been observed doing.
- ☐ At least two people in the building can certify a new coach.
- ☐ A Group Card exists for every training group — who's in it, what they're on, what the group's quirks are.
- ☐ An unplanned-coverage drill has been run in the last 90 days.

D • Family continuity

- ☐ All parent communication lives in a channel the facility controls and can read.
- ☐ Every active family is assigned to a named coach, and that assignment is written down.
- ☐ The last report each family received is retrievable by anyone at the desk.

☐ Every family's makeup usage this cycle is on a ledger, not in a conversation.

E • Facility continuity

☐ The emergency action plan is posted where an emergency happens — not in an office.

☐ Every slot's capacity number is written down, with the coach count it assumes.

☐ Somebody other than the owner can produce any of the above in under a minute.

Reading it

YES COUNT	VERDICT	WHAT IT MEANS
0-7	Person-dependent	The program is a person. If that person leaves, you are rebuilding from zero with families watching.
8-13	Fragile	Enough is written that you'd survive, but the handoff would be visibly rough and would cost you families.
14-17	Durable	A departure is a staffing problem, not a program problem. This is the target.
18-20	Coach-proof	The system is the asset, not the staff. This is what makes the facility sellable.

WHAT THIS SCORE IS REALLY TELLING YOU

A low Continuity Check with a high Adoption Audit means you have good systems living in one skull. That is the most dangerous configuration in this business, because it feels like success right up until the resignation email.

The ABIR Baseline

Athlete Buy-In Rate. This is the only number that puts a figure on engagement before and after the install, which makes it the cleanest proof the whole thing worked. Run it at day zero, then every cycle.

THE FORMULA

$$\text{ABIR} = (\text{P} \times \text{RI} \times 4) - \text{DP}$$

P = Participation, the average of five observable indicators, 1-5.

RI = Real Investment, the average of five observable indicators, 1-5.

DP = Distraction Points, ten named leaks scored 0 / 2 / 4, capped at 40.

Floor the result at 0. Never report a negative number to a coach — it stops being information and starts being an insult.

Scoring P — Participation

What the athletes physically do. Score each 1-5 for the group you're observing. Score what you see in one session, not what you remember about the month.

INDICATOR	1 — ABSENT	5 — INSTALLED
Attendance	Missing is normal and unremarked	Athletes attend, and absence is noticed the same day
On-time arrival	Session starts when enough people show up	Prep starts on the clock with the room already in it
Prescribed effort	Athletes work at whatever intensity they feel	Athletes hit the prescribed load and reps as written
Completion	Sessions trail off; the last block evaporates	Athletes finish the written session, including the close
Compliance without prompting	Every transition requires a coach's voice	The room moves on its own between blocks

P = sum ÷ 5 = _____

Scoring RI — Real Investment

What the athletes actually care about. This is the half almost every facility scores low, and the half that predicts re-enrollment.

INDICATOR	1 — ABSENT	5 — INSTALLED
Knows their own numbers	Cannot state their working load without looking	Knows their loads, their last test, and what they're chasing
Asks about progression	No questions beyond "how many more"	Asks what moves the number and what's next
Owens their log	Logging is done for them or not at all	Logs their own work without being asked
Trains when nobody's watching	Effort tracks exactly with coach proximity	Quality holds when the coach is across the room
Talks about the program	The weight room is a thing that happens to them	Refers to it as theirs — to teammates, to parents

RI = sum ÷ 5 = _____

THE COMPLIANCE ROOM

The most common profile in a paying facility is **P around 4 and RI around 2**. That is a compliance room. The athletes are doing what they're told and are not invested in what it produces. Compliance rooms look fine from the door and are the ones that quietly don't re-enroll. **If you recognize your building in that sentence, this is the highest-leverage page in the book.**

Counting DP — Distraction Points

Ten named leaks. Score each **0 (absent) / 2 (occasional) / 4 (routine)**. Maximum 40. The count tells you the size of the problem; the routing column tells you where the fix lives. That routing is the working half of this table.

#	DISTRACTION POINT	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	ROUTES TO	SCORE
1	Unclear session	Athletes don't know what today is until a coach announces it	Exercise Selection · Session Blueprint	
2	Unprescribed load	"Go by feel" — no weight on the sheet or the screen	Exercise Selection System	
3	Waiting	Athletes standing in line for a rack, a bar, or a coach	Zero Downtime Session Blueprint	
4	Coach-to-coach inconsistency	The standard depends on who's on the floor that day	Certification · Drift-Correction	
5	Overcoaching	Every rep narrated; the athlete never owns the movement	Certification · Standards	
6	Uneven attention	Coaching concentrates on a few athletes; the rest train unwatched	Certification · Standards	
7	Untracked attendance	Missing a week goes unnoticed	Data-to-Action Reporting	
8	Invisible progress	Nothing on the wall, no report, no visible number moving	ABIR · Progress-Visibility	
9	Program churn	The exercise changed again before the last one produced anything	Exercise Selection · Variation Myth	
10	Unenforced floor standards	Phones, side conversations, and drifting are tolerated	ABIR · Day-One Expectations	
DP TOTAL (0-40)				_____

Worked example

A group scores P 4.2, RI 2.4, DP 14. $4.2 \times 2.4 = 10.1 \rightarrow \times 4 = 40.3 \rightarrow - 14 = \mathbf{26.3}$.

That room looks fine from the door. Athletes are on time, sessions run, nobody causes problems. It scores 26 because nothing in it is producing investment and it's leaking fourteen points of distraction on top of that.

The bands

SCORE	BAND	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
75-100	Installed	Buy-in is a property of the system, not the coach's energy that day	Protect it. Re-score next cycle. Don't add anything.
55-74	Holding	Works, with known leaks	Work the top two distraction points. Nothing else.
35-54	Compliance	They show up, they do the work, and they have no idea whether it's working	Go straight to Progress Visibility (Part 7) and the Proof Report (Part 6).
0-34	Leaking	Both halves are failing and the distractions are structural	Stop scoring and go install standards. This is a Part 1 problem.

HOW TO USE THIS NUMBER LATER

Score every group separately, not the facility as a whole. A facility average hides the one group that's dragging retention. Re-run the same scorecard at day 90 with the same observer and the same groups — that before-and-after pair is the single cleanest piece of evidence that the install did something.

The Constraint Set

Six inputs, collected per training slot — never once for the whole facility. Everything in Parts 4 and 5 runs off these six numbers, and getting them wrong at the start invalidates both.

INPUT	SYMBOL	WHAT IT IS	HOW PEOPLE GET IT WRONG
Stations	S	Simultaneous work points in the room	Counting equipment instead of work points. Three dumbbell pairs on one bench is one station.
Athletes	A	Athletes booked into that slot	Using average attendance instead of booked. Book the seat, plan the seat.
Coaches	C	Coaches on the floor for the <i>whole</i> slot	Counting a coach who's there for twenty minutes, or who's at the desk.
Slot length	T	Door-to-door minutes	Using the advertised time instead of the real one. If they leave at 4:52, T ends at 4:52.
Turnover	X	Minutes between this group and the next	Assuming zero because the schedule says so.
Skill spread	E	Share of the group at ESL 1 / 2 / 3	Guessing. Count heads against the ESL definitions in Part 3.

Collection sheet — one row per slot, every slot on the board

SLOT	S	A	C	T	X	ESL 1 / 2 / 3

ONE CONSTRAINT SET PER SLOT

Never plan the week off the biggest group's numbers. **The 6:30 slot with one coach is a different room than the 3:30 slot with two.** Facilities that plan off one set consistently oversell the thin slots and undersell the strong ones.

Part 0 completion checklist

- ☐ Adoption Audit scored, all six components, with a total out of 18 written down and dated.
- ☐ Hours-per-week figure calculated and the annual recovery number written down.
- ☐ Continuity Check run, all 20 lines, verdict recorded.
- ☐ ABIR scored for every training group separately, not as a facility average.
- ☐ Constraint Set collected for every slot on the schedule, using real door-to-door minutes.
- ☐ All four results filed in one place with a date on them. This is the baseline you will certify against at day 90.



PART 1 • WEEK 1

Coach Certification & Standards

The first thing installed, because everything else is a standard and you cannot certify against standards that don't exist yet. This is where coach buy-in actually gets built.

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- 01 The Standards Session — three hours, six blocks
 - 02 The Standards Document — what the session produces
 - 03 The Certification Checklist — four tiers
 - 04 The Drift-Correction Protocol — five rungs
 - 05 Coverage & Handoff — surviving a departure

The Standards Session

Three hours, whole staff, in one room. This is the only genuinely non-negotiable time cost in the entire install, and it is the exact thing every piece of gym software you have ever bought failed to do.

WHY IT CANNOT BE A DOCUMENT YOU HAND OUT

A coach follows a standard he helped write. He tolerates a standard he was handed. **Those two things look identical in week one and completely different in month six.** If you write the standards document alone at your kitchen table and email it out, you have built a policy, not a system, and you will spend the next year enforcing it personally.

Before the session

- ☐ Whole staff scheduled — every coach who runs a group, including part-timers. Paid time, not a favor.
- ☐ Three uninterrupted hours. Not before a session. Not after a long day. Morning is best.
- ☐ Room with a wall you can write on or stick paper to. Everything gets written where everyone sees it.
- ☐ Adoption Audit and Continuity Check results printed — you will open with them.
- ☐ Phones in a box. You are about to ask for three hours of actual attention.
- ☐ You hold the pen. You do not supply the answers.

The six blocks

#	BLOCK	TIME	WHAT HAPPENS
1	The Read	20 min	You read the Adoption Audit out loud, without softening it. Then the Continuity Check. Then you say the sentence that reframes the whole session: <i>none of this is a coaching problem</i> .
2	Non-Negotiables	40 min	The staff names 5–7 things that are true in this building every session regardless of who is coaching. They propose, you gate for observability, the room votes.
3	The Floor Standard	45 min	Walk the session from door to door in phases. For each phase: what it looks like, how long it takes, who owns it, what "wrong" looks like.
4	The Coaching Standard	35 min	How a movement gets taught, how a correction gets given, how load gets decided, what buy-in behavior looks like on the floor.
5	The Data Standard	20 min	What gets logged, by whom, by when. Short block, and the one that makes Parts 6 and 8 possible at all.
6	Sign and Post	20 min	Read the whole document back. Every coach signs the same page. Date it. It goes on the wall before anyone leaves the room.

Block 1 — The Read

OPENING, SAY CLOSE TO VERBATIM

I want to start by reading you what I found when I audited this place, and I want to be clear about something before I do: none of this is a coaching problem. Every number I'm about to read is a systems problem, and systems are my job, not yours. [Read the six Adoption Audit components and the score for each. Then the Continuity Check verdict.] Here's what those two things mean together. We have good coaches doing good work, and almost none of it is written down anywhere. Which means the quality of a session in this building depends on which one of you is standing on the floor. That's not sustainable for you and it's not sellable for me. So today we're going to write down what "right" looks like in this building. Not what I think it should be – what we actually agree it is. And once it's written, it's the standard, and I'm going to hold every one of us to it, starting with me.

Block 2 — Non-Negotiables

Five to seven statements. These become Tier 1 certification lines verbatim, so the wording matters more here than anywhere else in the session.

THE OBSERVABILITY GATE

A proposed non-negotiable only goes on the wall if a person standing at the door could mark it met or not met **without asking a coach a single question**. "We're professional" fails. "Every athlete is greeted by name within the first two minutes" passes. Run every proposal through this gate out loud, in front of the room — the staff learns the standard for standards faster by watching you reject three than by hearing you explain it.

WHAT COACHES PROPOSE	WHY IT FAILS	WHAT IT BECOMES
"We treat athletes with respect"	A value, not a behavior. Unmeasurable.	"No athlete is corrected in front of the group for a first-time error"
"We start on time"	Close — but "on time" is undefined.	"Prep starts at the posted minute with the group already in the room"
"Everyone works hard"	Effort is not observable at a distance.	"Every athlete completes the prescribed sets at the prescribed load"
"Safety first"	Nobody disagrees, so nothing changes.	"Collars on every loaded bar, every set, no exceptions"

CAP IT

Seven is the ceiling. A list of fifteen non-negotiables has zero non-negotiables in it, because nobody can hold fifteen things in their head while coaching twenty athletes. If the room wants more, ask which one comes off.

Block 3 — The Floor Standard

Walk the session in phases. For each phase the room answers four questions, and you write the answers on the wall as they say them.

PHASE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	MINUTES	WHO OWNS IT	WHAT WRONG LOOKS LIKE
Arrival & check-in				
Start State				
Core 4 prep				
Primary block				
Blend / secondary				
Close & reset				
Transitions				
Late arrivals				

Late arrivals and transitions get their own rows deliberately. They are the two moments where every facility's standard quietly becomes "whatever that coach decides," and they are the two moments parents are most likely to witness from the door.

Block 4 — The Coaching Standard

Four lines, each of which becomes a Tier 2 certification item.

LINE	THE QUESTION THE ROOM ANSWERS
Teach sequence	When a movement is new to an athlete, what order does it get taught in, every time, by every coach?
Correction hierarchy	What is the first response to a missed rep? The second? At what point does the set stop?
Load rule	Who decides the weight, on what basis, and what is a coach allowed to change on the floor?
Buy-in behaviors	What does a coach do every session that produces investment rather than compliance? Name three observable ones.

TEEL

The coaching standard runs on four behaviors: **Teach, Energy, Encourage, Lead**. Teach is the movement. Energy is what the coach brings into the room before the athletes decide what kind of day it is. Encourage is specific and earned, never generic. Lead is the standard being held when holding it is inconvenient. If the room struggles to name buy-in behaviors, give them these four as the frame and let them fill in what each looks like here.

Block 5 — The Data Standard

Short, unglamorous, and the block that makes half this book function. Each logged item becomes a Tier 2 line.

ITEM	WHO LOGS IT	BY WHEN	WHERE
Attendance			
Working loads / top set			
Test results			
Limitations & modifications			
Session deviations			

THE DEADLINE IS THE STANDARD

"Logged before the coach leaves the building" is a standard. "Logged promptly" is not. Pick a moment, not an adjective — the whole reporting layer in Part 6 depends on data existing by a known time, not eventually.

Block 6 — Sign and Post

- ☐ Read the entire document back to the room, top to bottom, out loud.
- ☐ Ask once: "Is there anything on here you can't hold on a bad Tuesday?" Fix it now, not in month three.
- ☐ Every coach signs the same physical page. Not individual copies — one page, all signatures.
- ☐ Date it. Version it. Version 1.0, today's date.
- ☐ It goes on the wall before anyone leaves the room. Not "I'll print it tomorrow."

The Standards Document — the artifact

The session produces one document with four sections. This is its shape:

§	SECTION	CONTENTS	BECOMES
1	Non-Negotiables	5-7 observable statements, true every session	Tier 1 lines, verbatim
2	Floor Standard	Every phase: look, minutes, owner, failure mode. Plus transitions, late arrivals, reset.	Tier 1 lines, one per phase
3	Coaching Standard	Teach sequence, correction hierarchy, load rule, buy-in behaviors	Tier 2 lines
4	Data Standard	What gets logged, by whom, by when, where	Tier 2 lines

The Certification Checklist

The standards session produced a document. This turns that document into a pass/fail gate a coach walks through before he runs a session alone. Standards without certification are a suggestion.

A coach reads the standards doc, agrees with it, and then coaches the way he has always coached — not out of defiance, but because nothing ever checked. **Certification is the check.**

THE RULE THIS WHOLE SYSTEM RESTS ON

A line is signed off by **observation, never by conversation**. Not "he says he does it." Not "I've seen him around, he's fine." A certifier watched him do it on a live session, and put a date and initials next to it. If that didn't happen, the line is blank.

The four tiers

TIER	NAME	BY WHEN	WHAT IT UNLOCKS
0	Floor Ready	Day 1-3	Can be on the floor, supervised. Cannot run anything.
1	Session Ready	Day 7-14	Can run a group with a certified coach in the room.
2	Certified	Day 30	Runs a session alone. Counts toward staffing and toward capacity.
3	Standard Setter	Day 90+	Can certify other coaches. Removes the owner as the only certifier.

WHY TIER 3 IS NOT OPTIONAL

A certification system with one certifier is not a system — it is a dependency with paperwork. If the owner is the only person who can sign a coach off, every hire routes back through the exact bottleneck this install was bought to remove. **Tier 3 is what makes the system survive you being unavailable, and eventually, survive you leaving.** Below two Tier 3 certifiers, the facility is still a single point of failure.

The evidence rule

MARK	MEANS	WHAT HAS TO HAVE HAPPENED
Met	Signed off	A certifier watched him do it on a live session with real athletes, and initialed and dated the line.
Not yet	Open, with a date	Either not observed, or observed and missed. A re-observation date is written next to it.

THERE IS NO "FAIL"

Two marks only. **Met** and **Not yet**. A "not yet" with a date on it is a coaching plan. A "fail" is a verdict on a person, and it changes what the coach does next — he manages the paperwork instead of the behavior. This wording is not softness; it is what keeps the record honest.

ONE UNANNOUNCED OBSERVATION

Tier 2 requires at least one observation the coach wasn't expecting, because the standard you are certifying is the one that happens on an ordinary Tuesday. Tell coaches this rule up front — unannounced is not the same as sneaky, and saying so protects trust.

Building Tiers 1 and 2 from your own document

Tiers 0 and 3 are fixed at every facility and are written out below. Tiers 1 and 2 are built from your standards document, in the room, the week after the session.

FROM THE STANDARDS DOCUMENT	BECOMES	TIER
\$1 Non-Negotiables (5–7 lines)	One checklist line each, verbatim	1
\$2 Floor Standard (phases)	One line per phase: "Runs [phase] to standard — time, position, behavior"	1
\$2 Transitions, late arrivals, reset	Three lines	1
\$3 Coaching Standard	One line each: teach sequence, correction hierarchy, load rule, buy-in behaviors	2
\$4 Data Standard	One line per logged item: records it, correctly, by the stated deadline	2

Three rules for writing a line

1. **Verbatim beats better.** Copy their wording exactly, even where you could sharpen it. A coach signing off on a line he recognizes from the wall is signing off on something he helped write. A coach signing off on your improved version is signing off on somebody else's document, and it will not hold the same way in month six.
2. **One behavior per line.** If a line contains the word "and," check whether it is two observations. "Greet every athlete by name and starts on time" is two lines — a coach can do one and miss the other, and a single checkbox can't record that.
3. **Observable at a distance.** Could a certifier standing at the door mark this without asking a question? "Understands the correction hierarchy" fails. "Corrects a missed rep using the first-response cue before adding a second" passes.

CAP THE COUNT

Tier 1 lands at 10–14 lines. Tier 2 at 8–12. Past twenty on either and you have converted the standards document into a compliance form that no certifier will actually use. Cut to the lines that would tell you, on their own, whether this coach can be trusted with a group.

Tier 0 — Floor Ready

Day 1-3, before his first shift. Fixed at every facility. This tier is about safety, orientation, and names — not coaching. He runs nothing.

DEMONSTRATED BEHAVIOR	MET	NOT YET	CERTIFIER / DATE
States the facility's emergency action plan without prompting — who calls, who goes to the door, where the AED is			
Locates first aid, AED, emergency exits, water shutoff, and phone			
Names every piece of equipment in the room and its intended use			
Demonstrates safe bar loading, collar use, and rack pin height			
Demonstrates a spot on the facility's three most-spotted lifts			
Knows the arrival and check-in process athletes go through			
Knows every athlete's name in one assigned group			
Has read the standards document and can state the non-negotiables from memory			
Knows who to ask when he doesn't know — by name, not "somebody"			

Tier 1 — Session Ready

Day 7-14, two observed sessions on different days. Pulled from §1 and §2 of your standards document. Target 10-14 lines. He can run a group with a certified coach in the room.

LINE (WRITE IN FROM YOUR STANDARDS DOCUMENT, VERBATIM)	MET	NOT YET	CERTIFIER / DATE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			

Tier 2 — Certified

Day 30. Pulled from §3 and §4. Target 8–12 lines. At least one unannounced observation required. He runs a session alone and counts toward capacity.

LINE (WRITE IN FROM YOUR STANDARDS DOCUMENT, VERBATIM)	MET	NOT YET	CERTIFIER / DATE
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			

Tier 3 — Standard Setter

Day 90 and beyond. Fixed at every facility. This is the tier that removes you as the bottleneck. Two of these is the minimum for a facility that can survive a bad month.

DEMONSTRATED BEHAVIOR	MET	NOT YET	CERTIFIER / DATE
Has held Tier 2 for at least 60 days with no open not-yets			
Has observed and correctly marked a full tier on another coach, shadowed by an existing certifier			
Ran a Rung 1 floor correction on a peer, in the moment, without escalating it			
Can state the difference between individual and systemic drift and give an example of each from this building			
Has run a group he does not normally coach, off the Group Card alone			
Delivered a Day-One Expectations talk to a new athlete, observed			
Wrote a modification under the Train-Around Standard that passed the 0/0/0 test			

Coach record header — one per coach, kept in his file

Coach name	Start date
Primary groups	Assigned certifier

TIER	TARGET DATE	ACHIEVED	CERTIFIER
0 — Floor Ready			
1 — Session Ready			
2 — Certified			
3 — Standard Setter			

THE ONE-MINUTE TEST

The owner should be able to produce any coach's certification record in under a minute. If he can't, the system isn't installed — it's stored.

The Drift-Correction Protocol

Standards decay. Not dramatically — quietly, one convenient Tuesday at a time. This is how you put one back without turning it into a personnel event.

The A / B / C diagnostic — run this first, every time

Before you correct anybody, find out which of three things is actually happening. Correcting a Type B as though it were a Type A is the single fastest way to lose a good staff.

TYPE	NAME	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS, AND THE MOVE
A	Individual drift	One coach off a standard the rest of the staff is holding	A maintenance issue with one person — usually a habit that crept back, not a disagreement. Observe it yourself, then start at Rung 1.
B	Systemic drift	Most or all of the staff off the same standard	The standard is wrong, not the coaches. It did not survive contact with a real Tuesday. Correct nobody. Put the standard back in the room.
C	Silent drift	Nobody is visibly off standard, but the logs are thin, late, or empty	The floor looks fine and the data has quietly stopped. This is the one that kills the reporting layer months before anyone notices. Treat the deadline as the standard and re-certify the data lines.

THE THREE-COACH RULE

If three or more coaches are open on the same standard, it is **Type B by definition**. Stop correcting people. The standard is the problem.

Running a Type B correction

1. Announce that you are not correcting anybody. The staff expects it, and saying so buys you honest answers.
2. Observe the standard being missed on two different sessions, yourself.
3. Ask three coaches separately: *"What happens when you try to do this?"*
4. Diagnose the reason: not enough time in the slot, equipment doesn't allow it, group size makes it impossible, or it was written aspirationally in a quiet room.

5. Take it back to the room. Thirty minutes. They rewrite it. You hold the pen.
6. Reissue the standards document, dated and versioned, and re-certify only the lines that changed, within 30 days.

The five-rung ladder

CLIMBING RULE

Never climb more than **one rung per event**. Rungs are not a queue you work through — most drift is resolved at Rung 1 and never comes back.

#	RUNG	TRIGGER	HOW IT RUNS, AND THE FAILURE MODE
1	Floor correction	Observed once, in the moment	Ten seconds, on the floor, no audience, no follow-up paperwork. Any coach may run this on any peer. Fails when: it gets saved up and delivered as a Friday conversation — that turns a free correction into an ambush.
2	Documented not-yet	Same standard missed a third time after Rung 1 — or once, if it's a non-negotiable	The line comes off his certification record and goes back to "not yet," with a one-sentence behavioral note and a re-observation date set before the conversation ends. Fails when: the not-yet is opened and never closed. An open not-yet past its date does more damage than never opening one.
3	Re-certification of that line	The Rung 2 re-observation came back missed	A full observed session against that line and only

			that line, run by a <i>different</i> certifier than Rung 2. Fails when: you re-run a whole tier because one standard slipped.
4	Certification pulled	Rung 3 came back missed, on a non-negotiable	Tier 2 comes off. He no longer runs sessions alone or counts toward staffing until he re-certifies. Owner only. Fails when: there's no written route back — a demotion he can't reverse is a resignation on a delay.
5	Employment conversation	The pattern continues after a pull	Outside this system. The certification record — dated, observation-based, second-certifier verified — is what makes that conversation factual instead of personal.

Before you climb past Rung 3, answer three questions

- ☐ Has anybody actually *shown* him what "met" looks like, in a live session, since the not-yet? Telling is not showing.
- ☐ Is there a constraint making the standard impossible for his groups — group size, equipment, time slot? If so, this is Type B wearing Type A clothes.
- ☐ Was the standard ever delivered to him properly, or did he inherit it after the session he wasn't at?

RUNG 2 CORRECTION CONVERSATION — WITHIN 48 HOURS

I watched Tuesday's 4:00 and I want to talk about one thing, and one thing only. The standard is [read the line verbatim off the document]. What I saw was [describe the behavior, not the person – no adverbs, no "you always"]. I'm putting that line back to not-yet on your record. That's not a disciplinary thing and it's the same mechanism a new coach uses on the way up. It means I haven't seen it yet, so it's open. I'll be watching that line specifically on [date]. Between now and then, is there anything making that standard hard to hold with your groups? Because if there is, that's my problem to fix, not yours.

THE OWNER EXCEPTION — READ THIS ONE TWICE

The fastest way to kill a standards system is for the owner to break a standard once, publicly, for a good reason. Every coach in the room recalculates instantly, and the recalculation is correct: the standard is negotiable if the reason is good enough. If you need an exception, name it out loud as an exception, name the date it ends, and write it down. An unnamed owner exception is worth more drift than six coaches having a bad month.

Coverage & Handoff

Two versions of the same problem: a coach is out on Thursday, and a coach is gone in two weeks. Both are survivable and neither is survivable improvised.

The Group Card

One card per training group. This is the artifact that makes an unplanned coverage possible. It lives where anyone can grab it, not on a coach's phone.

FIELD	WHAT GOES IN IT
Group name & slot	Day, time, door-to-door minutes
Roster	Every athlete, with ESL level marked
Current block	What phase they're in, which week of it, what the primary lift is
Working loads	Where to find them in under 30 seconds
Limitations	Any athlete with an active modification, and what it is functionally
Group quirks	The two or three things a covering coach would otherwise learn the hard way
Parent notes	Any family in an open conversation, so the cover doesn't walk into it blind
Substitution rules	What a covering coach may change, and what he may not

The 30-minute unplanned coverage drill

Run this once per quarter. It is the only way to find out whether the Group Cards are real.

1. Pick a group at random. Pick a coach who does not normally run it.
2. Hand him nothing but the Group Card. Thirty minutes' notice.
3. He runs the session. You watch and do not help.
4. Afterward, score three things: did the session run to standard, what did he have to guess at, and what did he have to ask about.
5. Every guess and every question is a missing line on the Group Card. Add them the same day.

Handoff Readiness score — per group

CHECK	YES	NO
Group Card exists and is current within 14 days		
Working loads retrievable by a second person in under 2 minutes		
Next four weeks of programming exist in writing		
At least one other Tier 2 coach has run this group in the last 90 days		
Parent communication for this group lives in the channel of record		
Active limitations are documented, not remembered		

Six of six is handoff-ready. Four or five is survivable with friction. Three or below and that group belongs to a person, not to the facility.

The 14-day departure sequence

When a coach resigns, this runs on a clock, starting the day you're told. Do not let it drift into the last week.

DAY	WHAT HAPPENS
1	Group Cards for all his groups updated by him, in writing, with you in the room.
1-2	All parent communication for his families audited and moved into the channel of record. Anything on his phone is copied over now.
3	Successor named for every group, even if it's temporarily you.
4-7	Successor shadows every group at least once with the departing coach present.
7	Trigger touch to every affected family: the change, the new coach's name, and what stays exactly the same. Before they hear it from an athlete.
8-12	Successor runs every group with the departing coach observing, not coaching.
13	All logins, files, keys, and access transferred and confirmed.
14	Exit walkthrough against the Continuity Check. Anything he takes with him that isn't written down is a line you add to the next standards revision.

THE POINT OF ALL OF THIS

A departure should be a **staffing problem, not a program problem**. If a resignation changes what athletes experience on the floor, the system was never installed — it was borrowed from a person who has now left.

Part 1 completion checklist

- ☐ Standards session run in person, whole staff, three hours.
- ☐ Standards document written, all four sections, signed by every coach on one page, dated and versioned.
- ☐ Standards document posted where coaches see it — on the wall, not in a folder.
- ☐ Tier 1 lines built from §1 and §2, verbatim, 10–14 of them.
- ☐ Tier 2 lines built from §3 and §4, 8–12 of them.
- ☐ Certification record opened for every coach on staff, including tenured ones.
- ☐ Every existing coach's Tier 0 and Tier 1 observed and marked — do not grandfather anyone.
- ☐ Assigned certifier named for each coach.
- ☐ Drift ladder explained to staff out loud, including that peer correction at Rung 1 is their job.
- ☐ Group Card written for every training group.

☐ Coverage drill scheduled on the calendar for the end of the quarter.

The owner's four certification numbers

NUMBER	HOW TO READ IT	TARGET
% of staff at Tier 2 or above	The headline number, and the one to look at in month one	100%
Open not-yets by coach, with age	Anything past its re-observation date is the actual staffing risk in the building	Zero past date
Number of Tier 3 certifiers	Below two, the facility is still a single point of failure	2+
Days-to-Tier-2, last three hires	The ramp number — this is what the whole system was really for	Under 30



PART 2 • WEEK 1

Core 4 Movement Prep

The first thing in the building that every coach runs identically.
Fast, categorized, auditable prep — not fifteen minutes of random
stretches chosen by whoever is on the floor.

-
- 01 The four anchors and their subsets
 - 02 The prep library, by need
 - 03 The weekly prep sheet and the audit
 - 04 Progression, regression, and the direct-to-session rule

Core 4 Movement Prep

Prep is where facilities lose the most time and get the least credit for it. Core 4 fixes that by categorizing prep instead of collecting it — four anchor movements, each with named subsets, so a coach picks from a defined menu rather than from memory.

WHY THIS IS INSTALLED FIRST

Prep is the cheapest place in the building to prove a standard can hold. It's short, it's visible, it's the same every day, and every athlete and parent sees it. **A facility whose prep is identical across four coaches has just demonstrated to itself that the standards session worked.** Start the adoption here.

The four anchors

Four exercises anchor the entire prep system. Each one owns a set of subsets — the specific qualities that anchor is responsible for opening up. Every prep exercise you use should be attachable to one of the four.

ANCHOR	OWNS THESE SUBSETS	WHAT IT'S ACTUALLY BUYING YOU
Walking Lunge + Hip Airplane	Hip internal rotation · hip external rotation · hip extension	The hip in all three planes, standing, under a little load. Everything in the primary block that hinges or squats is paid for here.
Lat Pullover	Shoulder external rotation · shoulder flexion · thoracic extension	Overhead position. If athletes can't get there, you're either not pressing overhead or you're pressing overhead badly.
Dips	Shoulder internal rotation · shoulder extension	The back half of the shoulder, which almost every prep routine in the country skips entirely.
Standing Windmill	Thoracic rotation	Rotation from the mid-back rather than the low back. Every rotational and anti-rotational demand in the session depends on it.

The prep library, by need

This is the starting menu. Coaches select from it — they do not add to it on the floor. Adding to the library is a standards decision, made once, in the room.

Anchor 1 • Walking Lunge + Hip Airplane

SUBSET	OPTIONS
Hip internal rotation	Walking Hip Airplane · Adductor Rolling · 90/90 Over Back Knee · Kettlebell to IT · 90/90 Ankle Up
Hip external rotation	Figure 4 Rolling · Figure 4 Stretch · Frog Pose · Pigeon Pose · 90/90 Back Knee Up · Clam Shells · Butterfly Pose · Butterfly Pose Bridges · Half-Kneeling Lateral Lunge
Hip extension	Cobra Pose · Scorpion Pose · Couch Stretch · Pelvis Foam Rolling Hold · Medicine Ball Couch Stretch

Anchor 2 • Lat Pullover

SUBSET	OPTIONS
Shoulder external rotation	Shoulder-to-Side Banded ER · Side-Lying Banded ER · 90/90 Banded ER
Shoulder flexion & thoracic extension	Downward Dog · Hangs · Dumbbell Overhead Carries · Kettlebell Waiter Carries · Cat/Cow · Cobra Pose · Foam Roller Extensions · GHD Holds

Anchor 3 • Dips

SUBSET	OPTIONS
Shoulder internal rotation	Banded Shoulder IR · 90/90 Shoulder IR
Shoulder extension	Straight-Leg Raise Ups · Knee-Bent Dips · Crab Pose

Anchor 4 • Standing Windmill

SUBSET	OPTIONS
Thoracic rotation	Thread the Needle · Open Books · 90/90 Thoracic Rotation · Frog Pose with Rotation · Medicine Ball Rotation

The weekly prep sheet

One sheet per week, per group. Anchors down the left, days across the top. You fill in which subset exercise ran on which day.

CORE-4 ANCHOR	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
Walking Lunge + Hip Airplane							
Lat Pullover							
Dips							
Standing Windmill							

How to run it — four steps

1. **Start with an empty weekly prep sheet.** Not last week's sheet. Empty.
2. **With every subset exercise you place, check it off against its anchor,** so you can see all four getting hit across the week.
3. **When the week is written, audit it.** Where is the redundancy? Which anchor got three days of the same subset? Which subset never appeared?

4. **Repeat, week over week, phase over phase.** The audit trail is the point — over a phase it shows you exactly what you have and haven't been preparing athletes for.

THE PREP STANDARD

All four anchors are represented across every training week. No single subset runs more than three days in a row. **Prep is prescribed on the sheet, not chosen at the door.**

Progression and regression rules

SITUATION	THE RULE
Athlete can't reach the position	Regress within the same subset before changing subsets. The quality you're after doesn't change because the entry point did.
Athlete owns the position	Progress by adding load, range, or a standing/loaded variant — not by adding a fifth anchor.
Group is mixed	Same subset for the room, different entry points. This mirrors the macro/micro rule in Part 3 and for the same reason: one thing to coach.
Time is short	Prep does not get cut. See the block template in Part 4 — Core 4 is a fixed floor and the cut order never touches it.
Limitation present	Prep runs pain-free or it doesn't run. Route through the Modification Decision Tree in Part 9, same as any other movement.

DIRECT-TO-SESSION

Prep ends and the primary block begins with **no reset, no regroup, no second warm-up**. If athletes need a transition between prep and the first working set, the prep didn't prepare them — it entertained them. Prep is designed backward from the primary lift, every session.

Part 2 completion checklist

- ☐ The four anchors posted on the wall, with their subsets underneath.
- ☐ Prep library printed and available at the desk — coaches select from it, they don't add to it.
- ☐ Weekly prep sheet written for every group, one week ahead.
- ☐ Prep timed on the clock in a real session and confirmed to fit the block template's 15%.
- ☐ All coaches observed running prep to standard — this is a Tier 1 certification line.
- ☐ First weekly audit run: redundancy noted, missing subsets named.
- ☐ Direct-to-session tested — prep ends and the primary block starts with no gap.



PART 3 • WEEKS 2-4

The Exercise Selection System

The end of guesswork programming. A repeatable funnel that produces the same decision from any coach in the building, plus every step the Facility System Builder runs — so you can do it in the app or on paper.

-
- 01 ESL — Exercise Skill Level
 - 02 The 6 Whats — the selection funnel
 - 03 Macro vs. micro, and the Variation Myth
 - 04 Volume, load, and the 20-week rule
 - 05 The Adaptation Checklist
 - 06 The Facility System Builder — step by step

ESL — Exercise Skill Level

Every athlete carries a level and every exercise carries a demand. Matching the two is the whole job. ESL is the shared vocabulary that lets four coaches make the same call without a conversation.

ESL	ATHLETE	WHAT IT MEANS ON THE FLOOR	WHAT THEY GET
1	Learning	The movement is the training stimulus. Needs eyes on most sets. Position degrades under fatigue or load quickly.	Highest-constraint variation of the macro. Load is secondary to position.
2	Competent	Holds position under moderate load without cueing. Fails predictably and knows when it happened.	Standard variation, load progressed on schedule.
3	Owned	Position holds at high load and under fatigue. Can self-correct. Can teach the movement to a partner.	Least-constrained variation, highest load, and a supervision role in the room.

ESL IS PER MOVEMENT, NOT PER ATHLETE

A fourth-year athlete can be ESL 3 on a hinge and ESL 1 on an overhead press. **Rating the person instead of the movement is the most common mistake in this system**, and it's how a strong athlete gets handed a movement he isn't ready for on the grounds that he's "advanced."

THE SUPERVISION MULTIPLIER

An ESL 3 athlete is not just a training outcome — he is capacity. Pair ESL 1 with ESL 3, never ESL 1 with ESL 1. That single pairing rule is how a 20:1 room gets coached like a 12:1 room. See Part 4.

The 6 Whats

The selection funnel. Six questions, in this order, every time. Answered in sequence they produce one decision: **EX + EL + V** — the exercise, the external load, and the volume. That triplet is all the athlete ever sees.

THE OUTPUT

Final decision = EX + EL + V

Example: **EX** Barbell RDL · **EL** 315 · **V** 4 × 5 × 1000

The athlete sees a movement, a number, and a prescription. Every question above it is the coach's work, done before the door opens.

What 1 — What is the primary intent?

Everything downstream is set by this answer. Intent is not "get stronger." Intent is which of four qualities this exercise is being asked to deliver in this block.

INTENT	WHAT IT'S ASKING FOR	PRESCRIPTION THAT FOLLOWS
Execution	Learning the movement. The pattern is the point.	2-5 reps · + duration · + sets · – load
Output	Produce as much force as possible.	2-6 reps · – duration · – sets · + load
Durability	Maintain a position for a long period of time.	7-15 reps · + duration · + sets · – load
Express	Produce a lot of force in a short time.	1-3 reps · – duration · + sets · + load

THE MISTAKE THIS PREVENTS

Coaches pick the exercise first and then decide what it's for. That's backwards, and it's why programs drift into a collection of movements a coach likes rather than a sequence that develops anything. **Intent first. Always.**

What 2 — What is the primary joint?

Name one. Hip, shoulder, spine, knee, ankle, elbow, wrist. If you can't name a single primary joint, the exercise is doing two jobs and neither of them well.

What 3 — What is the primary movement of that joint?

JOINT	MOVEMENTS AVAILABLE
Hip	Flexion / Extension · Abduction / Adduction · Internal / External Rotation
Shoulder	Flexion · Extension · Horizontal Abduction / Adduction · Internal / External Rotation
Spine	Rotation · Anti-Rotation · Lateral Flexion · Anti-Lateral Flexion · Flexion / Extension · Anti-Flexion
Knee / Ankle / Elbow / Wrist	Flexion / Extension

Answering Whats 2 and 3 is what turns "leg day" into a decision you can audit. It also makes the Adaptation Checklist later in this part possible — you cannot audit what you never categorized.

What 4 — What is the best exercise option (EX)?

Now — and only now — you pick a movement. You're picking from the overall exercise library, filtered by everything above and constrained by everything below.

CONSIDERATION	WHAT YOU'RE ASKING
Facility constraints	Time, space, equipment. Does this movement fit the station count and the slot length?
Individual constraints	ESL on this movement. Any active limitation. Height, limb length, injury history.
Secondary / tertiary joint effects	What else does this movement tax? A hinge that hammers the low back changes what Thursday can be.
Other days' stress	What did this athlete do 48 hours ago and what does he do 48 hours from now?

Then **select the best variation** of that exercise for this athlete — which is a micro decision, and it's covered in the next section.

What 5 — What is the best external load (EL)?

CONSIDERATION	WHAT YOU'RE ASKING
What has he done in the past month?	Total load exposure. A big month means a conservative number this week.
What has he done on this exercise before?	The specific history on this specific movement — which only exists if the last twenty weeks were on the same movement. See the 20-week rule.

THE LOAD RULE

The program prescribes the weight. The athlete does not choose it and the coach does not improvise it on the floor. "Go by feel" is Distraction Point #2 on the ABIR scorecard, and it is one of the two most expensive words in a weight room.

What 6 — What is the best volume (V)?

Volume falls out of intent, from the table in What 1. Write it as **sets x reps x load** so the number the athlete sees is unambiguous — $4 \times 5 \times 1000$ is four sets of five at a thousand pounds of total work, and every part of it is prescribed.

VOLUME IS THE MOST IMPORTANT VARIABLE

Above frequency. Above exercise selection. If you get volume right and everything else approximately right, athletes progress. If you get exercise selection beautiful and volume wrong, they don't. **Order of importance: volume, then frequency, then exercise selection.** Most coaches spend their time on the third one.

The funnel on one line

RUN IT IN THIS ORDER, EVERY TIME

INTENT -> PRIMARY JOINT -> PRIMARY MOVEMENT -> EXERCISE -> LOAD -> VOLUME constrained by: time, space, equipment ESL and limitations secondary joint cost the rest of the week OUTPUT: EX + EL + V -> this is all the athlete sees

Macro vs. Micro, and the Variation Myth

The single most useful distinction in the system, and the one that makes mixed-skill groups coachable at all.

CHANGE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLES
Macro	A different exercise. New movement, new skill, new learning curve, new progression clock.	Back squat → trap bar deadlift. Bench press → landmine press.
Micro	A variation inside the same exercise. Same movement, same progression, same numbers still comparable.	Grip width. Stance. Tempo. Range. Implement. Unilateral vs. bilateral entry.

THE RULE THAT MAKES MIXED ROOMS WORK

One macro for the room. ESL sets the micro. The whole group trains the same movement. Skill level changes the variation of that movement, never the movement itself. This is why a first-week athlete and a fourth-year athlete can train in the same block without the coach splitting in half.

The Variation Myth

Coaches believe athletes need novelty. They don't. A small number of key movements done well over a long time drives progress; constant variation drives the appearance of progress and the reality of none.

WHAT COACHES BELIEVE	WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE
"They'll get bored on the same lift"	Athletes get bored when nothing is moving. A number that goes up every week is the least boring thing in the building.
"Variation prevents plateaus"	Changing the exercise resets the measurement. You didn't break a plateau, you stopped being able to see one.
"More exercises means more complete development"	Completeness comes from the Adaptation Checklist, not from exercise count. Audit the categories, not the variety.
"The new exercise is better"	Better than a movement he's had twenty weeks on? Almost never. Better than one he's had two weeks on? Irrelevant — neither has produced anything yet.

THE 20-WEEK RULE

An athlete stays on the same primary movement for roughly **twenty weeks** while volume progresses. Micro changes are free inside that window. A macro change requires a reason that is not boredom: a restriction, a constraint change, or the completion of the progression. **Program churn — changing the exercise before the last one produced anything — is Distraction Point #9 and one of the most expensive habits in a facility.**

PART 3 • SECTION 4

The Adaptation Checklist

The audit that catches what your programming is quietly missing. Not a planning tool — a review tool. You run it after the week is written, not before.

The five adaptations

ADAPTATION	WHAT IT DEVELOPS
Output (O)	To create as much force as possible
Hybrid (H)	To produce force over a long period of time
Durability (D)	To maintain a specific position for a long time
Express (E)	To assess the skill of the movement
Power (P)	To produce force quickly

The checklist grid

Fifteen movement categories × five adaptations. Every exercise you place in the week gets a check in one cell.

MOVEMENT	OUTPUT	HYBRID	DURABILITY	EXPRESS	POWER
Hip Flexion / Extension					
Hip Abduction / Adduction					
Hip Internal / External Rotation					
Spine Rotation					
Spine Anti-Rotation					
Spine Lateral Flexion					
Spine Anti-Lateral Flexion					
Spine Flexion / Extension					
Spine Anti-Flexion					
Shoulder Flexion					
Shoulder Extension					
Shoulder Horizontal Add / Abd					
Vertical Jump					
Horizontal Jump					
Lateral Jump					

How to run it — four steps

1. Start with an empty weekly programming sheet.
2. With every exercise you place into the program, check off the box that corresponds to the adaptation within that specific movement pattern.
3. Once the week is written, audit the checklist. Look for gaping holes. Where there are holes, look back at the program and find places the missing adaptation could go.
4. Repeat, week over week, phase over phase, so you can see what you are actually programming and where the program is thin.

READ THE COLUMNS AND THE ROWS

An empty *row* means a movement pattern you're not training. An empty *column* means a quality you're not developing anywhere. The second one is worse and almost nobody looks for it — most programs run heavy on Output and empty on Durability, then wonder why positions collapse in the fourth quarter of a season.

A worked weekly layout

This is what a written week looks like with intent assigned per day. Note that the movements repeat across the week and the *adaptation* changes — that's the 20-week rule in practice.

	MON OUTPUT	TUE HYBRID	WED DURABILITY	THU TESTING	FRI EXPRESS
Hip Flex/Ext	DB RDL BB RDL Trap Bar Deadlift BB Deadlift	Long stance lunge Stationary lunge FFESS · RFESS Step Up	B-stance RDL SL RDL	Sprint · Jump Change of direction	—
Hip IR/ER	Back Squat	Reverse Lunge	—	—	—
Sh. Hor Add/Abd	Floor Press DB Bench Press Push Up	—	—	—	BB Bench Press Push Press
Sh. Flex/Ext	Landmine Press OH Carries Tricep Extensions	Narrow-Grip Bench Dips Incline Curls	—	—	—
Spine	—	Anti-rotation Paloof Press	—	—	—

The Facility System Builder

Everything above, run as software. The app at **stsfacilitybuilder.netlify.app** executes the same funnel — it just does the sorting, the filtering and the calendar math for you. Below is every step it runs, with the paper equivalent beside it so the system works either way.

WHAT THE APP IS AND ISN'T

The app does not decide anything a coach shouldn't. It **enforces the funnel order**, filters the library so an unsuitable movement never appears as an option, and generates the 52-week calendar so nobody starts from a blank page. **Judgment stays with the coach. Sequence and arithmetic go to the machine.** Fifty-two weeks of programming generates in under three minutes.

The nine steps

#	STEP IN THE APP	WHAT IT'S ACTUALLY DOING	DOING IT ON PAPER
1	Enter facility constraints	Time, space, equipment. This is what makes the output yours rather than generic — every movement the room can't support gets removed from every menu downstream.	Write your station count, slot length, and full equipment inventory at the top of the programming sheet. Cross out every library movement you can't run.
2	Set the weekly layout	Assign an adaptation to each training day — Output, Hybrid, Durability, Express, Power, or a testing day. This is the skeleton the whole year hangs on.	Head each column of the weekly sheet with its adaptation. Do this before a single exercise goes in.
3	Assign movement categories per day	Which of the fifteen movement categories each day is responsible for. The app blocks a day that's carrying too many.	Write the categories down the left of each day.
4	Select primary joint and primary movement	Whats 2 and 3. Everything after this is filtered by the answer.	Name the joint and the movement for each slot in the day before you name an exercise.
5	Select intent	What 1 — Execution, Output, Durability, Express. This sets the rep, set, duration and load	Write the intent next to each slot and pull the prescription off the intent table.

	direction automatically.	
6 Pull the exercise from the library	What 4. The library is filtered by joint, movement, adaptation, available equipment and ESL, so what's left is a short list of legitimate options rather than a menu of everything.	Use the exercise library scaled easiest-to-hardest. Filter by hand: joint, movement, equipment you own, ESL of the group.
7 Assign volume	What 6. Sets, reps and duration prescribed from the intent, then progressed across the block rather than re-decided weekly.	Pull the rep and set range from the intent table. Write the progression for all twenty weeks now, not week by week.
8 Assign external load	What 5. Read against the athlete's history on that specific movement and his total load exposure over the past month.	Look up his last cycle on this movement. If you can't, that's the 20-week rule telling you something.
9 Generate and export	The 52-week calendar builds out, the adaptation audit runs automatically against the fifteen categories, and the output exports as the sheet coaches	Run the Adaptation Checklist by hand. Print the week. Post it.

actually run
from.

What the app checks that a coach won't

- ☐ **Adaptation gaps** — empty rows and empty columns across the week and the phase, flagged automatically.
- ☐ **Equipment conflicts** — two movements needing the same station in the same block.
- ☐ **ESL mismatch** — a movement offered to a group whose skill spread can't support it.
- ☐ **Progression length** — how many weeks the athlete has been on this primary, against the 20-week rule.
- ☐ **Macro churn** — a macro change made without a documented reason.

THE INSTALL STANDARD FOR THIS SYSTEM

Programming exists in writing, four weeks ahead minimum, for every group. Every athlete has a prescribed load. No coach writes a session on the floor. **If a coach can't produce next Tuesday's session right now, this system is not installed yet.**

Part 3 completion checklist

- ☐ ESL definitions posted and every athlete rated per primary movement — not per person.
- ☐ The 6 Whats posted where programming gets written.
- ☐ Macro vs. micro explained to the whole staff, with the one-macro-per-room rule stated out loud.
- ☐ Facility constraints written down: stations, equipment inventory, slot lengths.
- ☐ Weekly layout built — an adaptation assigned to every training day.
- ☐ Exercise library filtered to what this facility can actually run, and scaled easiest to hardest.
- ☐ Fifty-two weeks generated, or at minimum the current twenty-week block written in full.
- ☐ Adaptation Checklist run on the current week; gaps named and filled.
- ☐ Every athlete has a prescribed load on every primary movement.
- ☐ Substitution rules written: what a coach may change on the floor, and what he may not.
- ☐ Twenty-week clock started and recorded per group, so week count is a fact rather than a feeling.



PART 4 • WEEKS 2-4

The Zero Downtime Session Blueprint

How a group moves once it's in the room. Six inputs, five derived numbers, one block template that regenerates at any slot length — and an owner number that tells you whether your dead time is a coaching problem or a capacity problem.

-
- 01 The five derived numbers
 - 02 APS flow bands
 - 03 CAR supervision bands
 - 04 The block template and the cut order
 - 05 Mixed-skill grouping and the Filler Standard
 - 06 Back-to-back groups and the Dead Time Audit

The five derived numbers

The Constraint Set you collected in Part 0 produces five numbers per slot. Every decision in this part comes off one of them.

NUMBER	FORMULA	WHAT IT GOVERNS
APS	$A \div S$ athletes per station	How the room flows — solo, pairs, triads, waves. Sets the density of the session.
CAR	$A \div C$ coach-to-athlete ratio	What can be taught. High CAR means nothing new gets introduced in that slot.
U	$T - \text{entry} - \text{close}$ usable minutes	The minutes actually available for training, as opposed to the ones on the schedule.
R	observed reset time	Minutes to return the room to Start State. Sets the minimum turnover between groups.
DT%	$\text{dead min} \div U$ dead time percentage	The owner number. Where waiting is happening and whether it's fixable inside the session.

APS flow bands

Athletes per station determines how the room is organized. These are not preferences — they're what the arithmetic allows.

APS	BAND	HOW THE ROOM RUNS
1.0 - 1.5	Solo	Every athlete owns a station. Highest quality, lowest capacity. Rest is real rest.
1.6 - 2.5	Pair	Work/rest alternation is built in. The cleanest flow in the system and the easiest to coach.
2.6 - 3.5	Triad	Three-deep rotation. Needs a defined third job or the third athlete is waiting. This is the high-touch ceiling.
3.6 - 4.5	Wave	Groups rotate through in waves. Holds more athletes at lower coaching density. This is the volume ceiling.
Over 4.5	Breach	The room cannot hold this group at any acceptable standard. This is a Part 5 problem, not a coaching problem.

THE THIRD JOB

In triad and wave flow, every athlete has a job at all times: working, spotting or resetting, or executing a posted filler. **If the third athlete has no assigned job, you don't have a flow problem — you have a design problem.**

CAR supervision bands

CAR	BAND	WHAT'S ALLOWED IN THAT SLOT
Under 10	Teaching	New movements can be introduced. This is where anything with high cognitive load belongs.
10 - 15	Coaching	Known movements progressed, quality corrections available on most sets.
16 - 20	Managing	Known movements only. Corrections are triage. Nothing new gets taught here.
21 - 25	Supervising	Hard ceiling territory. Safety and standards only. Requires ESL 3 athletes doing real work.
Over 25	Not coachable	Not a session. Split it or staff it.

THE CLS RULE

Cognitive Load Score is the mental cost of what you're asking. **New movements are taught only in the week's lowest-CAR slot.** Teaching a new lift in a 22:1 room means teaching it to four athletes and letting eighteen invent it. That's how a bad pattern enters a program and lives there for a year.

PART 4 • SECTION 2

The block template

Five blocks, expressed as percentages of the slot, so the same template regenerates at 45 minutes or 90 without a coach doing arithmetic at the door.

BLOCK	% OF SLOT	WHAT IT IS	WHO OWNS IT
Entry & Start State	8%	Room already set, athletes in, check-in done. Prep begins on the clock.	Athletes
Core 4 Movement Prep	15%	The prep system. Fixed floor — this block does not shrink when the slot does.	Coach
Primary block	37%	The main lift. What everything else is built around, and the last thing ever cut.	Coach
Blend / secondary	30%	Derived work — positions and capacities the primary lift requires. Runs at the highest athlete-managed density of the session.	Athletes, coach patrols
Close & Reset	10%	Data logged, room returned to Start State by the athletes, not the coach.	Athletes

The template at four slot lengths

BLOCK	45 MIN	60 MIN	75 MIN	90 MIN
Entry & Start State	4	5	6	7
Core 4 Movement Prep	7	9	11	14
Primary block	17	22	28	33
Blend / secondary	13	18	23	27
Close & Reset	4	6	7	9
Total	45	60	75	90

The cut order

When time is lost, it comes out in this order, every time, without a decision being made in the moment. The point of a fixed cut order is that nobody has to think while twenty athletes watch them think.

1. **Blend / secondary volume** — cut sets, not exercises.
2. **Entry** — start the prep on the walk in.
3. **Close** — log on the way out, but the reset still happens.

NEVER CUT

The **Core 4** or the **primary block**. If those are getting cut, the slot length is wrong, and that is a Part 5 capacity problem, not a coaching decision. Escalate it — don't absorb it.

PART 4 • SECTION 3

Mixed-skill grouping

Groups are almost never clean. This protocol assumes a mixed room and holds coaching load flat anyway.

- **Group by ESL when the schedule allows it.** Same-skill grouping is always cheaper to coach. Ask for it before you engineer around not having it.
- **When it doesn't: one macro for the room, ESL sets the micro.** The whole group trains the same movement. Skill level changes the variation, never the movement.
- **Never run two macro variations in one block for one coach.** Two macros is two sessions. Coaching quality halves and dead time doubles.
- **Pair ESL 1 with ESL 3, never with each other.** An ESL 3 partner is a supervision multiplier — this is how a 20:1 room gets coached like a 12:1 room.
- **A group more than 40% ESL 1 is a teaching group.** Treat it as $CAR \leq 10$ or introduce nothing. If neither is possible, the group is scheduled wrong.

The Filler Standard

This is the answer to "what are athletes doing while they wait." The standard is that they are not waiting — they are assigned. **Fillers are posted at the station, not remembered by the coach.**

TIER	TYPE	WHAT IT IS	WHEN TO USE IT
1	Positional	A held position or mobility piece that serves the primary lift	Default. Costs nothing and pays into the movement being trained.
2	Preparatory	Low-load work for the next block's demand	When the blend block is about to ask for something the athlete isn't warm for.
3	Developmental	Genuine accessory work with its own progression	Only when rest intervals are long enough that it won't intrude.

THE FILLER RULE

A filler never raises the fatigue cost of the primary. If the filler is affecting the main lift, it isn't a filler — it's an unplanned second exercise, and you've just doubled the session's cost without doubling its value.

PART 4 · SECTION 4

Back-to-back groups & the Dead Time Audit

Start State

Start State is the defined physical configuration of the room at the beginning of every session: what's loaded, what's set, what's stacked, where everything lives. It is written down and posted, not assumed.

- ☐ Start State photographed and posted at the door.
- ☐ Close & Reset returns the room to Start State — the athletes do this, not the coach.
- ☐ Reset time (R) measured with a stopwatch on a real session, not estimated.
- ☐ Turnover between groups is at least reset time: $X \geq R$.
- ☐ Where $X < R$, the incoming group's first block is written as a reset block — never silently absorbed by the coach.

The Dead Time Audit

Dead time is any minute an athlete is neither working, resting on prescription, nor executing a posted filler. Standing in line is dead time. Waiting for a coach is dead time. Wandering is dead time.

How to run it

1. Pick a slot. Pick three athletes across different stations.

2. Time their dead minutes across the whole session with a stopwatch. Don't estimate.
3. Average the three. Divide by usable minutes (U). That's **DT%**.
4. Log it. Re-run monthly and after every schedule change.

DT%	READ	WHAT TO DO
≤ 10%	Healthy	Log it and move on. This is a well-run room.
11 - 20%	Flow problem	Check the Filler Standard first, then the APS band. Usually a missing third job. Fixable inside the session.
Over 20%	Capacity problem	Not fixable inside the session. Split the group or add a slot. Route to Part 5.

WHY THIS DISTINCTION MATTERS TO YOU AND NOT TO THE COACH

Above 20%, coaching harder makes it worse — the coach compresses instructions and quality drops while the waiting stays. An owner who treats a capacity problem as a coaching problem burns out good staff trying to fix arithmetic with effort.

Dead Time Audit log

DATE	SLOT	AVG DEAD MIN	USABLE MIN (U)	DT%	READ	ACTION TAKEN

Part 4 completion checklist

- ☐ APS and CAR calculated for every slot on the board.
- ☐ Any slot in the breach band flagged and routed to Part 5 before anything else is optimized.
- ☐ Block template applied to every slot at its real length, printed, and posted.
- ☐ Cut order posted where coaches see it.
- ☐ New-movement introduction assigned to the week's lowest-CAR slots only.
- ☐ ESL 1 / ESL 3 pairings set in every mixed group.
- ☐ Fillers written and physically posted at every station.
- ☐ Start State defined, photographed, and posted.
- ☐ Reset time measured with a stopwatch; turnover checked against it.

☐ First Dead Time Audit run and logged, with the read acted on.



PART 5 • WEEKS 2-4

Capacity & Scheduling

Which groups exist, when they run, how many seats each holds, and what happens when an athlete misses. The only system in the stack that puts a weekly dollar figure on your empty seats.

-
- 01 The Quality Ceiling — the one decision you make
 - 02 The capacity formula
 - 03 The capacity map and Open Seat Cost
 - 04 Seven scheduling rules
 - 05 The Makeup Session Policy

The Quality Ceiling

Capacity is not the number of athletes a room can hold. It is the number it can hold *at your own quality standard, with the coaches you actually have on the floor*. Those are two very different numbers, and the gap between them is where owners quietly lose money and quality at the same time.

Before any capacity number can be calculated, you set two ceilings in writing. They apply to every slot, forever, until deliberately changed.

CEILING	OPTIONS	WHAT IT MEANS
APS max athletes per station	3 = high-touch 4 = volume	At 3 the room runs triad flow and coaching quality stays high. At 4 the room runs wave flow and holds more athletes at lower quality. There is no third answer.
CAR max athletes per coach	20 default 25 hard ceiling	Above 25 the session is not coachable. Above 20 nothing new can be taught in that slot.

THE PRICE-VERSUS-VOLUME DECISION, MADE ONCE, IN THE OPEN

A facility charging premium per-athlete rates **cannot run APS 4 and defend the price**. A facility competing on volume cannot run APS 3 and make the math work. Pick one and let every slot inherit it. Facilities that never make this decision explicitly end up making it accidentally, slot by slot, in the direction of whoever is asking for a spot.

Our APS max: _____ Our CAR max: _____ Set on: _____

The capacity formula

THE FORMULA

Slot Capacity = the lower of (S × APS max) and (C × CAR max)

Space capacity and supervision capacity are two separate limits. The real capacity of a slot is whichever one runs out first. Everything above that number is sold quality, not sold seats.

EXAMPLE SLOT	SPACE CAP	SUPERVISION CAP	SLOT CAP	WHAT TO BUY
S=8, C=2, APS 3, CAR 20	24	40	24	Space-bound. Adding a coach adds nothing. Add stations.
S=14, C=1, APS 3, CAR 20	42	20	20	Supervision-bound. The room is half empty because there's one coach in it. Add a coach.
S=10, C=2, APS 4, CAR 20	40	40	40	Balanced. Both limits bind at once — growth requires both.

THE MOST USEFUL SENTENCE IN THIS WHOLE FRAMEWORK

The formula tells you **which thing to buy**. Most facilities buy equipment when they're supervision-bound, and hire when they're space-bound. The formula ends that guess, and it usually pays for the install by itself.

A COACH ONLY COUNTS IF HE'S CERTIFIED

C is the number of **Tier 2 or above** coaches on the floor for the whole slot. Counting an uncertified coach as capacity is how a facility books a slot it cannot actually run — and it's why Part 1 comes before Part 5.

PART 5 · SECTION 3

The capacity map

One row per slot. This is the document the schedule gets built from, and it is re-run at the start of every season and after every staffing change.

SLOT	S	C	CAP	BOOKED	OPEN	UTIL %	BAND
Mon 3:30	8	2	24	22	2	92%	Full
Mon 5:00	8	2	24	26	-2	108%	Breach
Mon 6:30	8	1	20	9	11	45%	Underfilled
Tue 3:30	8	2	24	18	6	75%	Healthy
Week total	—	—	184	131	53	71%	—

BAND	UTILIZATION	READ	ACTION
Underfilled	Below 60%	A revenue leak with a coach standing in it.	This is where makeups, trials and new enrollments go. Fill it before opening anything new.
Healthy	60 – 85%	Room to absorb growth and makeups without touching quality.	Hold. This is the target band.
Full	86 – 100%	Selling at capacity. No margin left.	Protect it. No makeups, no trials, no drop-ins. Plan the split now, before it breaches.
Breach	Over 100%	Quality is already being spent to hold athletes the schedule cannot hold.	Split this week. Not next season.

READ UTILIZATION PER SLOT BEFORE PER WEEK

A facility at 72% weekly can be at 104% on Tuesday and 38% on Friday — and the weekly number hides both problems.

Open Seat Cost

OPEN SEATS ARE A WEEKLY BILL

Open Seat Cost = open seats × (per-athlete monthly rate ÷ 4)

At 53 open seats and a \$175/month rate, the map above is leaking roughly **\$2,300 a week** in unsold, already-staffed inventory. Put that number in front of yourself every month. It's the number that makes scheduling feel urgent instead of administrative.

Our open seats: _____ × (rate _____ ÷ 4) = \$_____ per week = \$_____ per year

PART 5 • SECTION 4

Seven scheduling rules

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS
1 • Reset stagger	Turnover between groups is at least reset time ($X \geq R$). If it isn't, the incoming group's first block is <i>written</i> as a reset block — not absorbed silently by the coach.
2 • Split trigger	When booked exceeds slot capacity, the group splits. It is never absorbed. Splitting is a scheduling decision made once at a desk, not a coaching decision made at the door by whoever is on the floor.
3 • Peak slot protection	The two highest-utilization slots take no makeups, no trials and no drop-ins, ever. They're the slots most likely to breach and the slots most families are watching.
4 • Teaching load placement	Groups over 40% ESL 1 are scheduled into the lowest-CAR slots on the board. No coach runs more than two consecutive teaching-heavy slots.
5 • Adjacent station rule	Back-to-back groups don't open on the same station family, so nothing has to be torn down and rebuilt in the turnover window.
6 • One constraint set per slot	Never plan the week off the biggest group's numbers.
7 • Named overflow	Every slot has a named overflow slot written down <i>before</i> the season starts. When a slot hits Full, the next athlete has somewhere to go by name — not by negotiation.

The Open Seat Rule

Open seats are inventory with a fixed destination order. Nothing skips the order, and nothing enters a Full or Breach slot.

1. **New enrollment** — new revenue outranks everything.
2. **Trial** — future revenue.
3. **Makeup** — revenue already collected.
4. **Hold it open deliberately**, and record why.

The Makeup Session Policy

Most facilities have no written makeup policy, which means the policy is whichever coach is standing at the desk. That is a pricing decision being made by your least-paid employee, twenty times a month.

THE ONE-LINE STANDARD

A makeup is a **seat, not a session**. It goes into a slot that already exists and already has an open seat. It never creates a session, never adds a coach hour, and never enters a slot at Full or Breach.

The eight standards

1. A makeup is a seat, not a session.
2. **Eligibility is set by notice, not by reason.** You are not in the business of judging whose excuse was good enough.
3. Fourteen-day window, inside the billing cycle. Makeups don't bank.
4. Two per cycle, capped.
5. Placement only into slots at or below 85% utilization.
6. The athlete trains the day they land on. No custom programming for a makeup.
7. Logged as attended with a makeup flag, so attendance data stays true for the Proof Report.
8. **Nobody gets a different policy for asking.**

The eligibility table

SITUATION	MAKEUP?	WHY
Illness or injury	Yes	Notice given as soon as it existed. Health is never penalized.
School, team or family conflict reported 24+ hours out	Yes	Full notice. This is the behavior the policy is trying to produce.
Reported before the session, same day	Yes	The seat could still be re-sold or filled.
No-show, no contact	No	The seat was held, staffed and lost. This is the line that makes the whole policy work.
Late arrival	No	The session ran. A partial session is an attended session.
Travel or absence of a week or more	Not a makeup — a hold	Five makeups is a capacity problem. Route it to a membership pause instead.
Facility cancelled the session	Not a makeup — a credit	The facility's error is the facility's cost. It never spends a family's makeup allowance.

When the cap is hit

Three makeup requests in one cycle is a signal, not a problem family. It means the athlete is enrolled in the wrong slot, or the family is enrolled at the wrong frequency. Both are fixable and both are worth more than two free sessions.

- Requests cluster **in one slot across several families** → the slot is scheduled at the wrong time. Fix the schedule, not the families.
- Requests cluster **in one family** → move them to a slot that fits, or step them down in frequency. Route to the Complaint Protocol as a fit gap.
- Requests rise **facility-wide across a season** → read it against the capacity map before the next re-enrollment cycle.

The four desk scripts

GRANTING A MAKEUP

Got it – thanks for letting us know ahead of time. I have an open seat Thursday at 4:00 and Friday at 5:30. Which works? He'll train Thursday's session with that group, not Monday's – the week is what matters, not the day.

DENYING A NO-SHOW

I can't move that one to a makeup – we held and staffed the seat, so it counts as used. Anything you can text us before the session, even ten minutes before, and we'll always get you a makeup. Want me to add you to the group text so it's easy?

CAP REACHED

That would be the third makeup this cycle, and at that point I'd rather fix the actual problem than keep patching it. It looks like Mondays are hard for you – let's move him into the Wednesday group where you're already making it consistently. Same rate, better attendance, better results.

REQUESTED INTO A FULL SLOT

That group is at capacity and I won't add to it – it would change the session for the twenty-four athletes already in it. I have room Thursday at 4:00 or Friday at 5:30.

The owner's four capacity numbers

NUMBER	FORMULA	STANDARD	WHAT IT MEANS WHEN IT BREAKS
Utilization	Booked ÷ capacity, per slot	60 – 85% per slot	Below: unsold inventory. Above: quality is being spent to hold athletes.
Breach count	Slots over 100%	Zero	Any breach is a split that hasn't happened yet.
Makeup rate	Requests ÷ scheduled athlete-sessions	Under 10%	Above 10% is a scheduling problem, not a family problem. Read it by slot.
Open seat cost	Open seats × (monthly rate ÷ 4)	Trending down	The weekly dollar figure of the empty room.

Part 5 install sequence & checklist

- ☐ Quality Ceiling set with a decision made out loud — APS max and CAR max, in writing, once.
- ☐ Constraint set run on every slot and the capacity map built. One page.
- ☐ **Every breach resolved before anything else is touched.** Split, restaff, or move athletes to the named overflow slot.
- ☐ Overflow slot named for every remaining slot on the board.
- ☐ Open Seat Cost calculated and written down as a weekly and annual figure.
- ☐ Makeup Session Policy published to families and posted at the desk. Existing families get it in the next cycle's communication, not retroactively.
- ☐ Makeup ledger started — every request logged with notice type and ruling.
- ☐ Four owner numbers put on a monthly review date.
- ☐ Capacity map re-run date set for the start of next season.



PART 6 · WEEKS 4-8

Data-to-Action Reporting

Data that changes a decision, or it isn't data. What gets logged, how testing runs, what counts as real change, and the one-page report that justifies your price.

-
- 01 The Data Standard
 - 02 The testing cycle
 - 03 Meaningful change bands
 - 04 The Proof Report
 - 05 The three hard reports
 - 06 Automation rules

The Data Standard

Everything in this part and all of Part 8 rests on five things being logged, by a named person, by a stated deadline. If that isn't true, skip forward and go fix it — nothing downstream will work.

LOGGED ITEM	WHAT EXACTLY	DEADLINE STANDARD
Attendance	Per athlete, per session, with makeup and injury flags	Before the coach leaves the building
Working loads	Top set on the primary movement, per athlete	Same session, by the athlete, in the Close block
Test results	Every tested measure, with the date	Same day as the test
Limitations	Functional description, review date, who wrote it	Same session it appeared
Deviations	Anything run differently than written, and why	Same session

THE RULE THAT MAKES DATA WORTH COLLECTING

Every number has a **named decision it changes**. If a measurement doesn't change what somebody does, stop collecting it — you're paying coach time for decoration. Before adding any new metric, answer out loud: *what will I do differently when this number moves?*

The testing cycle

DECISION	STANDARD
Cycle length	8-12 weeks. Shorter than 8 and you're measuring noise. Longer than 12 and families go a quarter without proof.
Test week placement	A named week on the calendar, scheduled a year out. Not "when we get to it."
Same conditions	Same equipment, same protocol, same time of day, same order. A retest under different conditions is a new baseline, not a comparison.
Who tests	Tier 2 or above. Testing is a certification line.
What gets tested	Body mass, a velocity or load measure, a jump measure, a speed measure, and a conditioning or coordination measure. Five is plenty. Ten is a testing day nobody finishes.
Retest before the guarantee	The cycle must <i>complete</i> before day 90, or you're certifying adoption without proof.

Meaningful change bands

Without bands, every facility sells noise as progress, and every parent eventually notices. Set the band per measure, once, and hold it.

VERDICT	DEFINITION	HOW IT GETS REPORTED
Improved	Change exceeds the band for that measure	Named plainly, with the number and the date range.
Held	Change is inside the band, either direction	Reported as held , never as improved. Held is an honest and often correct outcome — in season, held is a win.
Down	Change is negative and outside the band	Reported, with the reason and the plan. Down cycles still ship.

THE HONESTY RULE

Noise is reported as held, never as improved. The first time a parent catches you selling a 0.4% change as progress, every number you ever show them afterward is discounted. Bands are what let you make a strong claim credibly.

PART 6 · SECTION 2

The Proof Report

One page, every athlete, every cycle, verdict first. This is the document that justifies a price increase, and the only artifact most parents will ever read closely.

The Proof Standard

- **Every athlete, every cycle.** Not the ones who improved.
- **Verdict first.** The parent should know the answer in the first line, not after four paragraphs of context.
- **Flat and down cycles still ship.** The reports you don't want to send are the ones that build the most trust.
- **One page.** A three-page report doesn't get read, which makes it a longer way of sending nothing.
- **A coach writes the verdict.** Numbers can be assembled by a machine. The sentence that interprets them cannot.

THE REPORT READINESS RULE

A report only ships if **attendance, loads and test data for that athlete are complete for the cycle.** An incomplete report is worse than a late one — it invites exactly the question you can't answer. If you can't ship, tell the family why, name the date you will, and fix the logging.

The five blocks

#	BLOCK	WHAT'S IN IT
1	The verdict	One or two sentences. Improved, held, or down, and the single thing that explains it. Written by the coach who runs the group.
2	Attendance	Sessions attended out of scheduled, with makeup and injury flags separated. This block contextualizes everything below it.
3	The numbers	Each measure with start, end, change, and the band verdict beside it. Four numbers maximum.
4	What we worked on	Two lines, plain language, on what this cycle was developing and why. Ties the numbers to the training.
5	What's next	What the next cycle targets and what the athlete controls. Ends forward, not backward.

The three hard reports

THE FLAT REPORT

Short version: his numbers held this cycle rather than moved, and I want to tell you why before you read the page. He's in season, he attended 14 of 16, and he's 11 weeks into a 20-week progression on his primary lift. Holding strength through a competitive season with that attendance is the outcome we were after – the growth cycle is the off-season block that starts [date]. What I am watching: [the one number that should move next]. If that hasn't moved by the next report, I'll change something and I'll tell you what.

THE DOWN REPORT

I want to be straight with you: two of his four numbers came down this cycle. Here's what I think happened – [the actual reason, named]. Here's what I've changed as of this week – [the specific change]. Here's what I expect to see by [date]. I'd rather send you this page than a version of it that made the quarter look fine. You'll get the next one the same way.

THE ATTENDANCE REPORT

Before the numbers: he made 7 of 16 sessions this cycle. That's the headline, and it's the reason the rest of the page reads the way it does. I'm not sending this to make a point about attendance. I'm sending it because I don't want you looking at flat numbers and concluding the training isn't working – the training didn't get a chance to. Can we talk about whether the slot he's in is the right one? If Mondays are the problem, I have room in a group that would fit you better.

NEVER AUTO-SEND THESE THREE

Flat, down, and low-attendance reports never leave the building without a coach reading them first. Automation assembles the numbers. A person writes the verdict and presses send. Getting this backwards is how a facility sends a cheerful automated progress report to a family whose kid hasn't been there in a month.

Automation rules

AUTOMATION MAY	AUTOMATION MAY NOT
Assemble the numbers from the tracker	Write the verdict
Apply the change bands and label improved / held / down	Send a flat, down or low-attendance report
Format and brand the page	Send anything for an athlete with incomplete data
Queue the report for coach review on a schedule	Decide which athletes get a report

Part 6 completion checklist

- ☐ Data Standard written into the standards document with named owners and deadlines.
- ☐ Attendance logging confirmed working and spot-checked against a real session.
- ☐ Testing cycle length chosen and test weeks placed on the calendar a year out.
- ☐ Test protocol written: measures, order, conditions, who runs it.
- ☐ Change band set for every measure, in writing.
- ☐ Proof Report template built, one page, five blocks.
- ☐ First full testing cycle completed — with a retest, not just a baseline.
- ☐ First Proof Reports written and sent for every athlete, including the flat ones.
- ☐ Report readiness rule enforced at least once — a report withheld and the reason communicated.



PART 7 • WEEKS 4-12

The ABIR System

Athlete buy-in, treated as a measurable property of the system rather than a property of the coach's energy that day. Four deliverables that take a compliance room and turn it into an invested one.

-
- 01 The Buy-In Scorecard (Part 0)
 - 02 The Athlete Onboarding Standard
 - 03 Day-One Expectations
 - 04 The Progress-Visibility Protocol

The Athlete Onboarding Standard

Every athlete goes through three windows. Onboarded is a status with a date on it, not a feeling the coach has about a kid.

WINDOW	WHEN	WHAT HAS TO HAPPEN
Window 1	Session 1	Day-One Expectations delivered, spoken not handed. Named coach assigned. ESL rated on primary movements. Medical flag checked against intake — if one exists, a limitation record opens before he touches a bar.
Window 2	Sessions 2-4	Baseline numbers taken. First prescribed loads on the sheet. Athlete logs his own work unassisted at least once. Knows where his numbers live.
Window 3	By session 6	The onboarding check: he states his own working load, names the movement he's progressing, and describes what happens if he misses a session. Passed or not-yet, dated, by a named coach.

THE ONBOARDING CHECK IS THE WHOLE POINT

An athlete who can't state his own load by session six is not going to develop investment on his own — he's going to develop compliance. The check is cheap, takes ninety seconds, and it is the single best early predictor of whether that athlete is still here in ninety days.

Intake load

New athletes cost supervision. Count them: **a new athlete inside Window 1 or 2 carries 1.25 against the slot's supervision capacity.** Three new athletes in one slot is nearly a fourth body of coaching load, and a slot that looks staffed on paper isn't.

What to track

- ☐ Sessions-to-onboarded, by coach. A coach whose athletes take twelve sessions is not delivering Window 1.
- ☐ Ninety-day retention, split by whether the onboarding check passed. This split is usually stark, and it's the number that makes the case for the whole system.
- ☐ Intake load per slot, so onboarding never quietly breaches a group.

Day-One Expectations

Three minutes, spoken, in Window 1. Seven expectations with a system response rather than a punishment — and five things the room owes the athlete back.

The seven expectations

EXPECTATION	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	SYSTEM RESPONSE WHEN IT'S MISSED
You start with the group	In the room and moving when prep starts	You join where the group is. You don't get a personal warm-up. Prep is the entry, not a favor.
You train the program that's written	The exercises on the sheet, in the order on the sheet	Coach walks you back to the written session. Substitutions come from a coach, not from you.
You use the weight that's prescribed	The number on the sheet or the screen, not the number you feel like	The set gets re-done at the prescribed load. A set at the wrong weight isn't a set, it's a warm-up.
You log your work before you leave	Your own log, entered by you, same session	You're not finished. The session isn't over when the last rep is; it's over when it's written down.
Your phone stays out of the session	In the bag from the first rep to the last	It goes in the bag. Second time, it goes at the desk until the session ends.
You tell us before you miss	A message ahead of the session, from you or a parent	Notice means the session is makeup-eligible. No notice means it isn't — and

that rule
doesn't bend
for anyone.

You reset your station	Bar stripped, plates racked, station back to Start State	The group doesn't leave until the room does. It's four minutes and it's everyone's.
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The five commitments — what the room owes the athlete

These are the five biggest distraction points, restated to the athlete as a promise. Each maps to a system that guarantees it. This half is what makes the first half enforceable.

THE PROMISE	GUARANTEED BY
You'll always know what you're doing today before you touch a bar	Written program, posted session
Your weights are prescribed, not guessed	Exercise Selection System
The prep is the same every day — no surprises at the door	Core 4 Movement Prep
When you're gone, somebody notices	Attendance standard and the communication cadence
You'll see your own numbers move, in writing, every cycle	Progress-Visibility Protocol and the Proof Report

THE GOVERNING RULE

Never correct a standard that was never delivered. If an athlete was never given the expectation out loud, the first conversation is delivery, not correction. And if the most-corrected expectation on your log depends on a promise the facility isn't keeping, **the facility broke its side first** — go fix that, not the athlete.

The delivery script

THREE MINUTES, SPOKEN, SESSION ONE

Before you touch anything, three minutes on how this room works. It's short and it goes both ways. Seven things we expect from you. [Deliver the seven, each with what it looks like and what happens when it's missed. Do not read them off a page — you know them.] Now five things you get from us, every session, and you should hold me to them. [Deliver the five commitments.] Last thing. Tell me back two of the seven and one of the five. [Wait. Fifteen seconds. Let it be awkward. This repeat-back is the difference between a talk you gave and a standard he owns.]

TWO THINGS THAT KILL THIS TALK

Handing it over instead of saying it. A printed sheet is a document he signed, not a standard he heard. **And value language.** "Be respectful," "have a good attitude," "work hard" — none of these are measurable, none can be corrected fairly, and every one of them gets enforced differently by different coaches. If you can't observe it from the door, it doesn't belong on the list.

The three-rung correction ladder

RUNG	WHAT IT IS	HOW IT RUNS
1	In-the-moment	Named, short, no audience. "Phone in the bag." Done. No record.
2	Named conversation	Same expectation, third time. Thirty seconds after the session, one-on-one. Logged.
3	Parent trigger touch	A trigger touch to the parent — <i>before</i> it becomes a complaint, not after. Factual, brief, and paired with what changes next.

Age-band delivery

AGE BAND	WHAT CHANGES
Middle school	Same seven, fewer words each. Lead with the commitments — younger athletes buy in on fairness before they buy in on standards. Repeat-back is mandatory.
High school	Full version as written. The repeat-back is where most of the value is.
College and above	Deliver it as a professional standard rather than a rule set. Lead with the load and logging expectations; they're the two that actually get broken.

The Progress-Visibility Protocol

The direct fix for the compliance room, and what makes commitment five true. Three layers, built in this order.

#	LAYER	WHAT IT IS	BUILD
1	The in-session number	The athlete sees a number at the rack, during the set — load, velocity, reps completed. Immediate, unmediated feedback.	First. Non-negotiable.
2	The Cycle Card	A short athlete-facing card at the end of every cycle, delivered in person in ninety seconds.	Second.
3	The wall	A standards board — not a leaderboard.	Optional. Last.

The Cycle Card

BLOCK	CONTENTS
1 • The verdict	First line. Improved, held, or down. Same change bands as the Proof Report — same numbers, athlete audience first.
2 • Your four numbers	Start, end, change. Four maximum.
3 • What you controlled	Attendance, logging, prescribed-load compliance.
4 • What we worked on	One line on the cycle's intent.
5 • What's next	The one thing that moves the next number.

THE FOUR-NUMBERS RULE

At least one of the four numbers must be entirely inside the athlete's control — attendance, sessions logged, prescribed-load compliance. This guarantees there is always something honest to show, even in a cycle where the physical numbers didn't move. Without it, a flat cycle produces a card that quietly says "you failed."

When nothing moved — the decision tree

#	CHECK	IF YES
1	Was attendance below threshold?	That's the verdict. Report it plainly and route to the attendance conversation. It's not a programming question yet.
2	Is he in season?	Held is the correct outcome and should be named as a win. Say the words: <i>holding through a season is the goal</i> .
3	Is he under twenty weeks on the primary?	Progression isn't finished. Report held, show the volume trend instead of the load, and name the week count.
4	Clean attendance, out of season, past twenty weeks, still flat?	Block the card entirely and route to a programming review. Do not hand this athlete a card.

BRANCH FOUR IS THE ONE THAT DOES REAL DAMAGE

An athlete with clean attendance, out of season, past twenty weeks, showing nothing, has a programming problem — not an effort problem. Handing him a card at that moment quietly blames him for your miss. That is the single most trust-destroying thing in this entire system, and it is completely avoidable by checking four boxes.

The standards board, not a leaderboard

- **Tiers, not ranks.** Named standards an athlete can reach, posted with who has reached them.
- **Every athlete must have a reachable tier.** If the lowest tier is out of reach for a first-year athlete, the board is a discouragement device with green paint on it.
- **Bodyweight never appears.** Not as a number, not as a ratio, not as a category. There is no version of a public bodyweight board that is worth what it costs.
- **Effort-controlled tiers exist too** — attendance streaks, sessions logged. These are the tiers that keep the board from being a genetics chart.

THE DELIVERY IS THE INTERVENTION

The Cycle Card delivered in person, in ninety seconds, by the coach who runs the group, is what moves Real Investment. The same card emailed home moves almost nothing. **Track delivery in person as the number — not cards produced.**

Part 7 completion checklist

- ☐ ABIR scored per group at baseline (Part 0) and the top two distraction points named.
- ☐ Onboarding standard written: three windows, named owner for each.
- ☐ Onboarding check scripted and run on every new athlete by session six.

- ☐ Intake load counted into slot capacity at 1.25 per new athlete.

- ☐ Seven expectations written in observable language — no value words.

- ☐ Five commitments written and each mapped to the system that guarantees it.

- ☐ Day-One script rehearsed out loud by every coach who delivers it.

- ☐ Correction ladder posted and the parent trigger rung explained to staff.

- ☐ In-session number visible at the rack for every athlete.

- ☐ Cycle Card built, with at least one athlete-controlled number.

- ☐ When-nothing-moved tree posted where cards get written.

- ☐ Standards board built with a reachable lowest tier and no bodyweight anywhere.

- ☐ ABIR re-scored at day 90 against the same groups and the same observer.



PART 8 • WEEKS 4-12

The Parent Trust System

Parents don't lose trust because results are bad. They lose it because they're uninformed. Four deliverables that prevent the complaint, handle the one that gets through, and turn a renewal into a review instead of a sales call.

-
- 01 The Communication Cadence
 - 02 The Proof Report (Part 6)
 - 03 The Complaint Protocol
 - 04 The Re-Enrollment Conversation

The Communication Cadence

Silence is not neutral. Silence gets filled — by the athlete's version of the day, by another parent in the parking lot, by the price on the card statement every month with nothing attached to it.

A parent who has heard nothing for three weeks is not a neutral parent. They are a parent building a case. **A complaint is almost never the first problem. It is the fourth or fifth problem, and the first four were silence.**

THE ZERO-SILENCE STANDARD

No active family goes longer than the silence threshold without a message that originated from the facility.

Two words carry the weight. **Active family** — every family currently paying, including the quiet ones. Especially the quiet ones; quiet is not satisfied, quiet is undiagnosed. **Originated from the facility** — a reply does not count. If the parent had to ask first, the cadence already failed. Answering well is customer service. Reaching out first is trust.

Setting the threshold

THRESHOLD	FITS	TRADE-OFF
7 days	Premium pricing, small rosters, high-touch positioning	Real coach time every week; won't survive a busy season unless partly automated
14 days	Default. Most multi-coach facilities	Enough rhythm to stay ahead of assumption, light enough to actually run
21 days	Floor. Large rosters, drop-in models	Below this, trust decays faster than you can rebuild it

Our threshold: _____ days. Channel of record: _____. Silence Gap review: _____ each week.

The four touches

TOUCH	WHAT IT IS	WHO WRITES IT	WHEN THE OWNER OF IT IS OUT
Onboarding	The first real message. Five answers with real numbers and a named date. Separate from the logistics email.	Owner or lead coach	Owner — never delayed. It's the first impression.
Rhythm	The recurring touch. 150-word cap, fixed send day, written by a human about that group's actual week.	Group coach	Covering coach, using the Group Card
Proof	The Proof Report at the end of each testing cycle.	Group coach	Owner sends from logged data
Trigger	Event-driven: absence, injury, coach change, correction ladder rung 3, rung advance.	Per the trigger table	Owner, no exceptions on same-day triggers

The trigger table — post this next to the standards document

EVENT	WINDOW	WHO
Two consecutive absences	Same week	Group coach
Any injury or in-session incident	Same day	Coach on the floor, then owner
A limitation opened or a modification written	Same day	Coach who wrote it
Return-to-lift ladder started, rung advanced, rung failed	Same week	Tier 2 coach
Correction ladder rung 3	Same day	Group coach
Coach change on their group	Before the first session with the new coach	Owner
Schedule or policy change	Two weeks ahead	Owner

Channel of record

One channel. Email by default. Everything a parent receives goes through it and stays visible to the facility.

- No facility communication in a channel the facility can't see — no personal cell numbers, no DMs, no group chats a coach owns.
- Text is permitted for same-day triggers only, and the same message gets logged in the channel of record.
- When a coach leaves, the entire parent history stays.

COMMON MISTAKE

Letting each coach run parent communication however he likes because he's good at it. It works right up until he leaves, and then the facility discovers **it never had a relationship with those families at all** — the next coach starts from zero with a family who has been here two years.

The Inbound Standard

INBOUND

Acknowledged within 1 business day. Resolved, or scheduled with a named date, within 3.

Acknowledged is not solved, and it doesn't need to be. The parent isn't waiting for an answer — they're waiting to find out whether they were heard.

INBOUND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Got it. I'm looking into this today and you'll hear back from me by Thursday.

Common mistake: waiting until you have the full answer before replying. Three silent days while you investigate reads identically to three silent days while you ignore them.

The Silence Gap — the owner's number

The Silence Gap is the count of active families currently past the threshold. It is the only number this system asks you to look at.

- ☐ Target: **zero**.
- ☐ Checked weekly, same day every week, on your calendar.
- ☐ Any family two thresholds deep goes on the owner's desk, not the coach's.
- ☐ A Silence Gap climbing two weeks in a row is not a parent problem — it's a staffing or workload problem showing up in the parent channel first.

Five drift indicators

Cadence doesn't collapse loudly. It fades. These are the five signs it has stopped running before a single parent complains.

1. The Silence Gap climbs two weeks in a row. *Primary indicator — everything else is confirmation.*
2. Rhythm touches start reading identical cycle to cycle. Copy-paste means nobody is in the room writing it. **Systemic.**
3. A parent's first message is a question the cadence should have already answered. Every one of these is a missed touch with a name on it.
4. Trigger touches keep getting sent by the owner instead of the coach. The coaches have quietly handed the relationship back. **Systemic.**

5. Complaints arrive already escalated — angry, at the owner, first contact. That means the small version had nowhere to go.

Indicators 2 and 4 are systemic drift. Route them to the Drift-Correction Protocol in Part 1 rather than handling them as one-off conversations.

Cadence install checklist

- ☐ Silence threshold chosen and written into the standards document.
- ☐ Channel of record chosen; every coach has access; personal-channel communication ended.
- ☐ Every active family assigned to a training group, and every group to a named coach.
- ☐ Onboarding touch written for each program you sell — the five answers, real numbers, a named date.
- ☐ Logistics email separated from the onboarding touch.
- ☐ Rhythm touch template loaded, 150-word cap set, send day fixed on the calendar.
- ☐ Trigger table posted where coaches see it — same place as the standards document.
- ☐ Attendance logging confirmed working; the absence triggers can't fire without it.
- ☐ Ownership matrix filled in with real names, including the out-of-office column.
- ☐ Inbound standard communicated to staff: 1 day to acknowledge, 3 to resolve or schedule.
- ☐ Silence Gap review on the owner's weekly calendar, same day each week.
- ☐ Baseline Silence Gap measured on day one and written down.

The Complaint Protocol

Cadence prevents complaints. This only cleans up what cadence missed. Every complaint is one of four types, and each type routes to a different system — which means the complaint is diagnostic information about your operation, not just a bad afternoon.

TYPE	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE	WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS	ROUTES TO
Information gap	"I didn't know he'd been moved groups"	A missed touch. Almost always the most common type, and the cheapest to fix.	Communication Cadence
Value gap	"I'm not sure what we're paying for"	Proof isn't reaching them, or isn't legible when it does.	Proof Report · Progress Visibility
Experience gap	"He says he stands around a lot"	Something real on the floor. Verify it before you defend it.	Zero Downtime · Certification
Fit gap	"We wanted more sport-specific work"	They want something you don't sell. Not a failure — a mismatch.	Re-enrollment · release

THE REQUIRED FIELD

Every logged complaint requires one entry: **which touch was missed before this?** Nine times out of ten there is one, and writing it down is what converts complaint handling from customer service into system repair.

Escalation — by type and repeat, not by volume

SITUATION	WHO HANDLES IT
First instance, any type	The group coach. Same day acknowledgement.
Second instance, same family, same type	Owner joins. The pattern is now the subject, not the incident.
Any experience gap involving safety	Owner immediately, same day, before any defense of the coach.
Three families, same type, 30 days	Systemic. Stop handling complaints and go fix the named system.

NO COACH IS PENALIZED FOR SURFACING A COMPLAINT

Say this out loud in the standards session. A facility where reporting a complaint is risky is a facility where the owner finds out at cancellation. The coach who brings you a complaint on Tuesday saved you a family.

Scripts by type

INFORMATION GAP

You're right, and that's on us – you should have heard that from me before he told you. Here's what happened and here's what changed: [fact, then fix]. I've also changed how that goes out so the next family doesn't find out the same way.

VALUE GAP

Fair question, and I'd rather answer it with the page than with an opinion. Here's his last two cycles side by side. [Walk the numbers.] Here's what moved, here's what held and why, and here's what the next block is going after. If that isn't the kind of progress you were expecting, tell me now rather than in June – because that's a conversation I can actually do something with.

EXPERIENCE GAP

I'm not going to tell you that's wrong before I go look. I'll be on the floor for that session Thursday and I'll time it myself. If he's waiting, that's a real problem and it's mine to fix. I'll tell you either way by Friday.

FIT GAP — THE RELEASE

I want to be honest with you, because I think it saves us both a season. What you're describing isn't what we do here. We're a [describe the actual offer plainly], and what you want is [name it]. I could bend the program toward it and I'd do it badly. Here's who I'd send you to instead. No hard feelings and the door's open if that changes.

The monthly read

Once a month, sort the complaint log by type and answer one question: *which system produced the most complaints this month?* That system is your next project. Not the loudest family — the most frequent type.

The Re-Enrollment Conversation

Re-enrollment is a review, not a sales conversation. If the previous three deliverables ran properly, you walk in already qualified. If they didn't, you find out here — eight weeks before a cancellation would have told you.

The Readiness Gate

Four checks, each answered by a system already running. If the answer is no, the gate tells you which conversation to have *instead*.

CHECK	ANSWERED BY	IF NO, HAVE THIS CONVERSATION INSTEAD
Three consecutive Proof Reports delivered	Proof Report — sent history	None yet. You haven't given them proof. Fix your side, hold the price, come back next cycle.
Cadence held — no silence gaps this cycle	Silence Gap review	None yet. A family who hasn't heard from you is not ready to be asked for more.
No complaint open or closed in the last 30 days	Complaint log	Close the loop first. Re-enrollment waits a cycle.
Attendance above the facility threshold	Proof Report — attendance row	The attendance conversation. It's a different conversation, and it comes first.

FAILING THE GATE IS NOT A LOSS

It is the system telling you the truth eight weeks earlier than a cancellation would have.

The four families

Segment before you script. Proof and attendance are the two axes, and they produce four different conversations. Running the same one on all four is how facilities lose good families and keep bad fits.

SEG	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU NEVER DO
A Proven & consistent	Three reports, numbers moved, attendance strong	Raise the price. Ask for the referral after they say yes.	Apologize for the number
B Proven, inconsistent	Reports fine, attendance below threshold	Have the attendance conversation. Hold the price this cycle.	Raise the price on a family who wasn't here
C Unproven	Reports missing, cadence gaps — your side failed	Name it out loud, hold the price, commit to the next cycle in writing.	Raise the price to cover your own miss
D Fit gap	They want what you don't sell	Reframe honestly, or release.	Bend the program to keep them

SEGMENT C BUILDS THE MOST TRUST OF ANY MOVE IN THIS BOOK

A facility that says "we didn't get you what we promised this cycle, so we're not raising your rate" buys something no marketing spend can. Do not skip it because it's uncomfortable. It is the highest-return sentence available to you.

Five price rules

1. **The review comes before the number.** Walk the reports first. The price is the last thing said, not the first.
2. **Notice is given in writing, 30 days minimum,** before the conversation happens.
3. **Grandfathering is a policy, not a favor.** Decide it once, apply it to everyone who qualifies.
4. **The price is named plainly, with no discount attached to it.** No apologizing, no softening, no "but I can do something for you." *A price you immediately offer to reduce was never a price.*
5. **Nobody gets a different number for asking.** The moment one family gets a discount for pushing, your pricing is a negotiation and the families who didn't ask are subsidizing the ones who did. If you want tiers, build tiers — don't improvise them at the kitchen table.

Objection scripts

"CAN YOU DO ANYTHING ON THE PRICE?"

I don't discount, and the honest reason is that it wouldn't be fair to the families paying the full rate for the same thing. What I can do is change what he's in. [Fewer days a week / a different group] runs at [price]. Same standard, less of it.

"WE'RE GOING TO THINK ABOUT IT."

Of course. Take the reports home with you – that's the actual picture, not my opinion of it. The next block starts [date] and I'll hold his spot until [date]. If I haven't heard by then I'll assume he's out for this one and I'll open it up – no hard feelings either way.

THE REFERRAL ASK — SEGMENT A ONLY, AFTER THE YES

One more thing, and no pressure on it – most of the athletes in here came from a parent telling another parent, not from an ad. If you know a family who'd get something out of this, send them my way. I'll take care of them the same way.

What to track

NUMBER	WHAT IT TELLS YOU
Renewal rate	The headline. Read it by segment or it hides everything useful.
Price realization	Actual average rate vs. published rate. Any gap is discounting you didn't decide to do.
Renewal by segment	Segment A renewing at anything under 90% means the conversation, not the product, is the problem.
Gate failures by check	Which of the four checks fails most often. That's your weakest system, named.

Part 8 completion checklist

- ☐ Silence threshold set and the Zero-Silence Standard posted.
- ☐ Channel of record established; personal-channel parent communication ended facility-wide.
- ☐ Every family assigned to a group and a named coach.
- ☐ Rhythm touch running on a fixed day, written by coaches, under 150 words.
- ☐ Trigger table posted and at least one trigger touch fired correctly and on time.
- ☐ Silence Gap measured weekly and trending to zero.
- ☐ Complaint log started, with the required missed-touch field.
- ☐ Monthly complaint read run once, with a named system as the output.
- ☐ Readiness gate run against the roster before any re-enrollment conversation.

☐ Roster segmented A / B / C / D.

☐ Price rules written down, including the grandfathering policy.

☐ Referral ask made to Segment A families only, after the yes.



PART 9 • DAY ONE & ONGOING

The Return-to-Train Protocol

Every other system in this book is sold on what it adds. This one is judged by what it prevents. Your coaches are making the call on a hurt athlete in the next ninety seconds whether or not anything is written down.

-
- 01 The Train-Around Standard
 - 02 The Return-to-Lift Ladder
 - 03 The In-Session Emergency Protocol
 - 04 The Medical Handoff

POST THE EMERGENCY PROTOCOL ON DAY ONE

Regardless of where the rest of your install sits. Every other system's absence is an inefficiency. This one's absence is a liability. **And your emergency plan is currently in a binder in an office — nobody in an emergency walks to an office.** It goes on the wall, in the room, today.

PART 9 • SECTION 1

The Train-Around Standard

Limited athletes train. The question is never whether — it's what.

The eight standards

These are non-negotiable. They get read out loud in the standards session, and every coach signs the same page.

1. **Limited athletes train.** Nobody is sent home for being limited. A modified session is a session, and it is logged as attended.
2. **We log function, not diagnosis.** Record what the athlete cannot do — "right shoulder, painful overhead, fine below shoulder height" — never what we think is wrong with it.
3. **Train around pain, never through it.** Pain is a stop signal, not a load signal. There is no coaching context in which pushing into a painful range is the right call.
4. **Unaffected regions keep their full volume.** An ankle does not cancel the upper body. Volume is the variable that drives adaptation, and losing six weeks of it everywhere because one joint hurts is a bigger setback than the injury.
5. **Modify the exercise, not the schedule.** Same slot, same block, same coach, same training intent. Micro first, macro second, reallocate last.
6. **Red flags end the session and leave the building.** From that point the coach's job is documentation and handoff, not assessment.
7. **Every limitation has a review date.** No limitation goes past fourteen days without either a documented medical touch or a written re-check.
8. **Nothing enters the Return-to-Lift ladder without documented clearance.** Train-Around is not a return progression and cannot be used as one.

The Modification Decision Tree

Four questions, in this order, every time. **The order matters more than the answers** — running question two before question one is how a facility trains an athlete through a fracture.

Question 1 — Is this a red flag?

If yes, this is not a training decision. Stop the athlete, document what you saw, notify the parent the same day, and route them out to a provider. Do not modify. Do not "see how it feels."

STOP AND REFER IMMEDIATELY

- Loss of consciousness, or any suspected blow to the head or neck
- Visible deformity, or a suspected fracture
- A joint that locks, catches, or gives way under the athlete
- Inability to bear weight, or an obvious change in how they walk
- Numbness, tingling, or weakness traveling down a limb
- Pain present at rest, or pain the athlete says wakes them at night
- Significant swelling that appears within an hour
- Chest pain, shortness of breath, dizziness, or fainting
- Sharp, unfamiliar pain in the same spot across three sessions despite correct modification

Question 2 — Can the movement be done pain-free anywhere?

If any portion of the pattern is pain-free, stay in the movement family and make a **micro** change: shorten the range to the pain-free portion, change the stance or grip, change the implement, slow the tempo, or cut the load. Same block, same intent, same exercise on the card. This is the answer most of the time, and it's the one that protects a twenty-week progression instead of restarting it.

Question 3 — If not, what else buys the same adaptation?

Go **macro**: a different pattern that trains the same quality. A painful squat becomes a hinge. A painful overhead press becomes a landmine press. The block goal doesn't change — the movement selected to deliver it does. Run the swap through the same 6 Whats funnel you use for everything else.

Question 4 — If nothing in that region is pain-free, reallocate.

Take the region out entirely and put the session's work everywhere else: unaffected regions at full volume, the contralateral limb, trunk work that doesn't load the site, and conditioning that keeps the site quiet. The athlete still trains hard for the full slot. **Training the healthy side is not a consolation prize** — it preserves strength on the side you cannot touch.

THE 0 / 0 / 0 TEST — THE RULE THAT KEEPS A MODIFICATION HONEST

A modification is approved only if it produces **no pain during the set, no pain after the session, and no pain at the next session**. All three, every time. Fail any one and drop back one step: reduce range first, then load, then swap the pattern. **Two consecutive fails is not a third modification — it is a medical touch.**

The limitation record

FIELD	WHAT GOES IN IT
Athlete	
Opened by / date	
Functional description	What he cannot do. Not a diagnosis.
Modification written	Micro / macro / reallocate, and the specific change
0/0/0 result — session 1	
0/0/0 result — session 2	
Review date (max 14 days)	
Medical touch / clearance on file	

WHO WRITES A MODIFICATION

Tier 2 or above only. Tier 0 and Tier 1 coaches run the session that's already written. A facility that skipped Part 1 cannot run this system safely — that's not a policy preference, it's the actual reason the tier system exists.

The Return-to-Lift Ladder

The four-rung progression from documented clearance back to full training. Entered only with clearance, advanced only by an exit test, signed only by a Tier 2 or above.

RUNG	WHAT IT IS	THE EXIT TEST THAT OPENS THE NEXT RUNG
1	Pattern	The movement, unloaded or near-unloaded, through the full prescribed range, 0/0/0 clean across two consecutive sessions.
2	Load	Working load restored to a defined percentage of pre-injury or of the group standard, at prescribed reps, 0/0/0 clean.
3	Rate	The movement performed at speed and under fatigue — the quality that was never tested by rungs 1 and 2, and the reason athletes get hurt after clearance.
4	Full	Full training week, full volume, no modification on the card. Release documented.

SKIPPING RUNG 3 IS THE CLASSIC FAILURE

Load comes back, everybody feels good, and the athlete goes from heavy and slow to a full sport week. **He gets hurt in practice, not in your building — which is exactly why nobody traces it back to the ladder you cut short.**

How duration changes the ladder

TIME OUT	WHAT HAPPENS TO THE PROGRESSION
Under 3 weeks	Same primary, same twenty-week count. The weeks out don't count toward the twenty — add them to the end.
3 to 8 weeks	Same primary, and the week count restarts from the week he clears rung 2. He isn't starting over on the exercise — he's starting over on the progression.
Over 8 weeks, or surgical	New baseline working load after rung 1, and a fresh twenty-week count on the same primary.
Any duration, with a restriction that rules the exercise out	One macro change, documented, with the reason written down. The new movement becomes the primary and carries its own full twenty weeks.

INJURY IS NOT A REASON TO CHANGE THE EXERCISE

A restriction changes the exercise. Boredom, novelty, and the urge to make a comeback feel fresh do not. Keeping the movement is what makes the return readable: same lift, same numbers, so the load chart tells you whether he's recovering. **Change the movement and you've thrown away the only measurement you had.**

Who runs the ladder

- A **Tier 2 or above** coach writes the ladder and signs every rung advance. Tier 0 and Tier 1 run the session that's already written and log 0/0/0 — they do not advance anybody.
- **The owner does not advance a rung.** Not for a parent, not for a college visit, not for a playoff. The exit test is the only door, and an owner who overrides it once has removed the standard for everyone.
- An athlete on rungs 1 and 2 counts **1.25 against supervision capacity**, same as a new modification. Rungs 3 and 4 count as one.

What gets said, and to whom

MOMENT	WHO HEARS IT	WHAT IT IS
Clearance received	Parent, sport coach	A trigger touch: the ladder starts, here's what the first two weeks look like, here's what we are not doing yet.
Rung advance	Athlete, then parent	The athlete hears it first and hears <i>why</i> — the exit test he just passed. This is the single best buy-in moment in the whole protocol.
Rung failure	Parent	Same week, plainly: he repeats the week, here's why, here's what would change it. Silence here is how a rung failure becomes a complaint.
Release	Parent, sport coach, provider	In writing, with the record: dates, rungs, loads.

SAY THIS OUT LOUD IN THE RELEASE CONVERSATION

Return to lifting is not return to play. What the facility supplies is a record of what the athlete has done under load. The play decision belongs to the provider and the sport coach.

Four common mistakes

- **Calendar rungs.** "Six weeks post-op, so he's on week six of the program." Time is information about tissue, not about capacity. The exit test is the only thing that knows whether he's ready.
- **Chasing the old number.** The athlete wants his pre-injury lift back by a date, and the coach quietly agrees. Every reinjury inside a weight room starts with somebody chasing a number that used to be true.
- **Changing the exercise on the way back.** It feels like a fresh start and it destroys the measurement.
- **Skipping rung 3.** See above. This is the one that shows up as a practice injury three weeks later.

PART 9 • SECTION 3

The In-Session Emergency Protocol

Posted in the room. Rehearsed, not read. Three roles, named by position rather than by person, so it works on a Saturday with the coach who wasn't at the meeting.

ROLE	WHAT THAT PERSON DOES
Coach on the athlete	Stays with the athlete. Does not leave, does not go get anything, does not make phone calls.
Coach who calls	Calls emergency services, states the address out loud, stays on the line.
Coach at the door	Goes to the entrance and physically brings responders in. Clears the path.

With only two coaches, roles two and three collapse into one and the room is cleared by athletes. Write that version down too — the two-coach version is the one you'll actually run.

The posted card contains

- ☐ Facility name and full street address, written out, in the largest text on the card.
- ☐ Nearest cross street and the door responders should use.
- ☐ AED location, in plain words.
- ☐ First aid kit location.
- ☐ The three roles.
- ☐ Owner's phone number and the second call.
- ☐ Where the emergency contact list lives.

Three compliance reads for the Command Center

CHECK	STANDARD
Certification currency	Every coach's CPR/AED current, with expiry dates tracked. Zero expired.
AED check	Monthly. Battery, pads, expiry. Logged with initials.
Rehearsal age	Emergency walk-through rehearsed within the last 90 days, whole staff.

These are three of the cheapest compliance reads in the entire operation and the three most expensive to be missing.

PART 9 • SECTION 4

The Medical Handoff

The only piece in this book that pays for itself in new athletes. You are already generating this paperwork — sending it is what turns it into a referral channel.

A facility that sends release summaries to the three clinics already on its intake forms is building a referral relationship out of documentation it was going to produce anyway. Clinicians and sport coaches want exactly one thing from you that they can't get anywhere else: **a record of what the athlete has actually done under load.**

The handoff document

SECTION	CONTENTS
Header	Athlete, dates of limitation, date of clearance received, date of release.
Functional limitation	What he could not do, in functional terms, as it was logged.
Modification history	What was run instead, and the 0/0/0 results.
Ladder record	Each rung, the date cleared, and the exit test result.
Load chart	The primary movement's loads across the return. This is the part they actually want.
Statement	"This is a record of training load only. Return-to-play determination belongs to the provider."

Building the channel

- ☐ List the three clinics that appear most often on your intake forms.
- ☐ Send a release summary to the referring provider for every athlete you release, with parent consent.
- ☐ Include one line offering to send the same for any athlete they send you.
- ☐ Track referrals in, by clinic. This becomes a named acquisition channel within two quarters.

The owner's four Return-to-Train numbers

NUMBER	HOW TO READ IT	TARGET
Documented releases	Releases with all four exit tests logged and signed. Anything under 100% means somebody is advancing athletes on feel.	100%
Rung-failure rate	Advances that had to drop back. Some failure is healthy — zero means the tests are too easy or nobody is logging honestly.	10–25%
Re-injury within 90 days of release	Same region, same athlete. This is the number that tells you whether rung 3 is real.	Under 5%
Time to release, by region	Your own benchmark, built from your own athletes. Read the trend, and read outliers against the coach who ran them.	Trend

Part 9 completion checklist

- ☐ Emergency card written and posted in the room — day one, before anything else in this book.
- ☐ Two-coach version of the emergency protocol written down.
- ☐ AED check logged this month; CPR/AED expiry dates tracked for every coach.
- ☐ Emergency walk-through rehearsed with the whole staff.
- ☐ Eight Train-Around standards read out loud in the standards session and signed.

- ☐ Red flag list posted where coaches can see it from the floor.
- ☐ Modification decision tree posted.
- ☐ Limitation record template built and in use, with a 14-day review date on every open record.
- ☐ Modification menu rewritten against your own equipment.
- ☐ Return-to-Lift ladder template built with your exit tests defined.
- ☐ Tier 2 gate enforced — only certified coaches write modifications or advance rungs.
- ☐ Supervision weighting (1.25) applied to limited athletes in the capacity map.
- ☐ Medical handoff template built and sent for at least one release.
- ☐ Three referral clinics named and contacted.



PART 10 • ONGOING

The Owner Command Center

The dashboard that reads the other nine. Four gates, one weekly email, and a 90-day certification that tells you whether you installed a system or bought yourself a filing cabinet.

-
- 01 The System Adoption Rate — four gates
 - 02 The weekly owner read
 - 03 The 90-Day Certification
 - 04 The owner's rhythm

System Adoption Rate (SAR)

One number, four gates. SAR measures adoption, not activity — whether the floor is running the system, not whether the system exists.

GATE	THRESHOLD	WHAT IT MEASURES	WHEN IT'S SHORT
Logged	90%	Sessions with complete data by the stated deadline	Silent drift — Type C. Re-certify the data lines. Everything else depends on this one.
Attendance	90%	Athlete-sessions recorded against scheduled	Either logging or a real attendance problem. Check the logs before blaming families.
Testing	100%	Athletes with a completed test cycle	The reporting layer has nothing to stand on. This is the gate facilities skip.
On plan	85%	Sessions run as written, deviations documented	Coaches overriding the program. Route to drift correction, and run the A/B/C diagnostic before correcting anybody.

ALL FOUR — NOT THE AVERAGE

An average lets a facility certify at 91% with testing at zero. **Each gate clears on its own or the system is not adopted.** This is the single most-gamed number in operations software and the reason it's specified this way.

The weekly owner read

Fifteen minutes, same day every week. Six numbers, in this order.

#	NUMBER	SOURCE
1	The four SAR gates	This part
2	Silence Gap	Part 8 — should be zero
3	Open not-yets past their date	Part 1 — the actual staffing risk in the building
4	Breach count	Part 5 — should be zero
5	Open limitations past 14 days	Part 9
6	Open seat cost	Part 5 — read monthly, but glance weekly

THE OWNER'S JOB IN THIS SYSTEM

Not to run the floor. To read six numbers weekly and act on the flagged coach, the flagged family, and the flagged slot. **If reading these six takes more than fifteen minutes, the systems underneath aren't producing them automatically yet.**

PART 10 • SECTION 2

The 90-Day Certification

Four checkpoints. This is the honest test of whether you installed anything, and it's the same standard a paid install is held to.

STOP	WHAT IT IS	ITS ROLE
Day 0	Baseline	Adoption Audit + Continuity Check + ABIR, run before anything is installed. No gates scored — this is the number you certify against.
Day 30	Trajectory check	Trajectory only. Logging is the one that has to be moving by now — everything else depends on it.
Day 60	Last fixable point	The last point where a miss is still fixable inside 90 days. Two gates short here means it's time to change the plan, not push harder.
Day 90	Certification	The one that counts. Scored on the 28 days ending today , not on the whole 90.

What you owe the system for this to be fair

In a paid install these are the client's obligations, and the clock pauses when one goes unmet. Doing this yourself, they're the six ways you'll sabotage your own install without noticing.

- ☐ All coaching staff attended the in-person standards session.
- ☐ Every coach has their own login — not a shared owner account.
- ☐ Devices are staged and charged before each training day.
- ☐ The weekly numbers get read, and flagged coaches get followed up.
- ☐ The roster is kept current — new and departing athletes updated within a week.
- ☐ No program overrides outside the written substitution rules.

THE PAUSE CLAUSE

If one of the six goes unmet, the 90 days stop counting until it's restored. **You cannot certify adoption at a facility that hasn't issued its coaches logins.** Log the pause in writing the day it starts — including when the person breaking the obligation is you.

What is not certified

SAY THIS PART OUT LOUD

Athletic outcomes are not guaranteed. This certifies **that the system is being run** — not that a given athlete jumps higher. That's the line that makes the rest of the promise believable, and it's the line that keeps you honest with families.

Re-certification

Certification is dated, not permanent. Re-run it every 90 days. **A facility that certifies in November and stops logging in January is no longer certified, and the report should say so.**

Certification scorecard

GATE	THRESHOLD	DAY 30	DAY 60	DAY 90	CLEARED
Logged	90%				
Attendance	90%				
Testing	100%				
On plan	85%				

BASELINE VS. DAY 90	DAY 0	DAY 90	CHANGE
Adoption Audit (of 18)			
Continuity Check (of 20)			
ABIR — group 1			
ABIR — group 2			
Hours/week across the six			
Open seat cost / week			

The owner's rhythm

CADENCE	WHAT YOU DO
Weekly	The six-number read. Silence Gap review. Follow up on any flagged coach or family.
Monthly	Capacity numbers — utilization, breach, makeup rate, open seat cost. Complaint log read by type. Dead Time Audit on one slot. AED check.
Per cycle (8-12 wks)	Testing cycle completes. Proof Reports go out. Cycle Cards delivered in person. ABIR re-scored.
Quarterly	Certification re-run. Coverage drill. Continuity Check re-run. Emergency rehearsal. Capacity map rebuilt.
Seasonally	Capacity map re-run from scratch. Standards document reviewed and re-versioned if anything changed. Re-enrollment conversations.



PART 11

The 14-Week Install Calendar

Week by week. What you do, and what has to be finished before the next week starts.

Week by week

Doing this yourself, the constraint is your hours, not the sequence. If a week slips, slip the whole calendar — do not skip ahead to the part that feels more urgent.

WEEK	FOCUS	WHAT YOU DO	FINISHED BEFORE YOU MOVE ON
0	Baseline	Adoption Audit. Continuity Check. ABIR per group. Constraint Set per slot. Post the emergency card.	Four baselines dated and filed. Emergency card on the wall.
1	Standards session	Three hours, whole staff, six blocks. Document written, signed, posted same day. Core 4 anchors posted.	Signed standards document on the wall, version 1.0, dated.
2	Certification build	Convert §1–§2 to Tier 1 lines, §3–§4 to Tier 2. Open a record for every coach. Start Tier 0 observations.	Tier 1 and 2 line sets written. Every coach has an open record.
3	Core 4 + selection setup	Prep library posted. Weekly prep sheets written. Facility constraints and equipment inventory logged. ESL rated per athlete per primary movement.	Prep running identically across all coaches. ESL ratings complete.
4	Programming build	Weekly layout by adaptation. Exercise library filtered. Generate the block — 52 weeks or the current 20-week block in full. Run the	Four weeks of programming in writing for every group, with prescribed loads.

		Adaptation Checklist.	
5	Session flow	APS and CAR per slot. Block template applied and posted. Cut order posted. Fillers written and posted at stations. Start State defined and photographed.	Every slot has a printed session plan at its real length.
6	Capacity	Quality Ceiling set. Capacity map built. Every breach resolved. Overflow slots named. Open Seat Cost calculated.	Zero breaches on the board. Capacity map on one page.
7	Makeups + data standard	Makeup policy published to families and posted at the desk. Makeup ledger started. Data standard enforced — attendance and loads logging daily.	Logging happening every session without reminders.
8	Testing	Test protocol written. Test week run. Change bands set per measure. First Tier 2 certifications signed off.	Baseline test data complete for every athlete.
9	Parent cadence	Threshold set. Channel of record established. Families assigned to coaches. Onboarding and rhythm touches written. Trigger table	First rhythm touch sent by coaches, not by you.

posted.
Baseline
Silence Gap
measured.

10	ABIR install	Onboarding standard live. Day-One Expectations written and rehearsed. In-session number visible at the rack. Correction ladder posted.	Day-One talk delivered to the next new athlete, observed.
11	Return-to-Train	Eight standards signed. Red flags and decision tree posted. Limitation records opened for every currently limited athlete. Ladder template built. Emergency rehearsal run.	Every limitation in the building documented with a review date.
12	Proof	Retest. Proof Reports written and sent for every athlete. Cycle Cards delivered in person. Complaint log started.	Every family has received a Proof Report.
13	Command Center	SAR gates calculated. Weekly read scheduled. Coverage drill run. Group Cards audited against what the drill exposed.	Six-number weekly read taking under fifteen minutes.
14	Certification	Re-run Adoption Audit,	A dated certification, honest about what's still open.

Continuity
Check, ABIR.
Score the four
gates on the
last 28 days.
Compare to
baseline.
Name what
didn't clear.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE FOUR WEEKS

Run weeks 0, 1, 2 and 7 — baseline, standards session, certification build, and the data standard. That's the minimum viable spine. Everything else in this book is built on those four, and a facility that has only those four is still meaningfully more durable than it was on Monday.



PART 12

Master Checklist & Failure Modes

Every box in the book, in one place — plus the eleven ways installs die, so you can recognize yours early.

The master checklist

Part 0 — Baseline

- ☐ Adoption Audit scored, dated, hours-per-week calculated
- ☐ Continuity Check run, 20 lines, verdict recorded
- ☐ ABIR scored per group
- ☐ Constraint Set collected per slot

Part 1 — Certification & Standards

- ☐ Standards session run in person, whole staff, three hours
- ☐ Standards document written, signed on one page, dated, posted
- ☐ Tier 1 and Tier 2 lines built from the document, verbatim
- ☐ Certification record open for every coach, including tenured ones
- ☐ Assigned certifier named per coach
- ☐ Drift ladder explained; peer correction named as everyone's job
- ☐ Group Card written for every group
- ☐ Path to two Tier 3 certifiers named

Part 2 — Core 4

- ☐ Four anchors and subsets posted
- ☐ Prep library available at the desk
- ☐ Weekly prep sheet written a week ahead
- ☐ Prep timed and fitting the 15% block
- ☐ Direct-to-session confirmed — no gap between prep and primary

Part 3 — Exercise Selection

- ☐ ESL rated per athlete per primary movement
- ☐ The 6 Whats posted where programming gets written
- ☐ Facility constraints and equipment inventory written down

- ☐ Weekly layout built by adaptation
- ☐ Twenty-week block generated in full, with prescribed loads
- ☐ Adaptation Checklist run; gaps named and filled
- ☐ Substitution rules written
- ☐ Twenty-week clock started and recorded per group

Part 4 — Zero Downtime

- ☐ APS and CAR calculated per slot; breaches escalated
- ☐ Block template applied at real slot lengths, printed and posted
- ☐ Cut order posted
- ☐ New movements assigned to lowest-CAR slots only
- ☐ ESL 1 / ESL 3 pairings set
- ☐ Fillers posted at every station
- ☐ Start State defined and photographed; reset time measured
- ☐ First Dead Time Audit run and logged

Part 5 — Capacity & Scheduling

- ☐ Quality Ceiling set in writing
- ☐ Capacity map built; every breach resolved
- ☐ Overflow slot named for every slot
- ☐ Open Seat Cost calculated weekly and annually
- ☐ Makeup policy published and posted; ledger started
- ☐ Four capacity numbers on a monthly review date

Part 6 — Data-to-Action

- ☐ Data standard written with owners and deadlines
- ☐ Attendance logging confirmed and spot-checked
- ☐ Test weeks on the calendar a year out; protocol written

- ☐ Change band set per measure
- ☐ Proof Report template built — one page, five blocks
- ☐ Full cycle completed including a retest
- ☐ Report readiness rule enforced at least once

Part 7 — ABIR

- ☐ Onboarding standard live, three windows, named owners
- ☐ Onboarding check run by session six
- ☐ Intake load counted at 1.25 into capacity
- ☐ Seven expectations written observably — no value words
- ☐ Five commitments written and mapped to systems
- ☐ Day-One script rehearsed out loud by every deliverer
- ☐ In-session number visible at the rack
- ☐ Cycle Card built with an athlete-controlled number
- ☐ When-nothing-moved tree posted
- ☐ Standards board built — reachable lowest tier, no bodyweight

Part 8 — Parent Trust

- ☐ Silence threshold set; Zero-Silence Standard posted
- ☐ Channel of record established; personal channels ended
- ☐ Families assigned to groups and named coaches
- ☐ Rhythm touch running on a fixed day, under 150 words
- ☐ Trigger table posted; one trigger fired correctly
- ☐ Silence Gap measured weekly, trending to zero
- ☐ Complaint log started with the missed-touch field
- ☐ Monthly complaint read run once
- ☐ Readiness gate run; roster segmented A/B/C/D

- ☐ Price rules and grandfathering policy written
-

Part 9 — Return-to-Train

- ☐ Emergency card posted in the room
 - ☐ Two-coach version written
 - ☐ AED checked; CPR/AED expiries tracked; rehearsal run
 - ☐ Eight standards signed
 - ☐ Red flags and decision tree posted
 - ☐ Limitation records open with 14-day review dates
 - ☐ Modification menu rewritten against your equipment
 - ☐ Ladder template built with exit tests defined
 - ☐ Tier 2 gate enforced on modifications and rung advances
 - ☐ 1.25 supervision weighting applied in the capacity map
 - ☐ Medical handoff sent; three referral clinics contacted
-

Part 10 — Command Center

- ☐ Four SAR gates calculated and read weekly
 - ☐ Six-number weekly read scheduled and under fifteen minutes
 - ☐ Facility obligations met, or the pause logged in writing
 - ☐ Day 30 / 60 / 90 checkpoints scheduled
 - ☐ Day 90 re-run of all three baselines completed and compared
 - ☐ Quarterly re-certification date on the calendar
-

Eleven ways this dies

Almost no install fails on the build. They fail in one of these eleven ways, and every one of them is visible weeks before it's fatal.

#	FAILURE MODE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE, AND THE FIX
1	You wrote the standards yourself	The document is better and nobody follows it. There's no shortcut — get the staff in a room and rewrite it with them holding the pen.
2	You certified by conversation	"He's been here four years, he's fine." Now the record is fiction and drift correction has nothing factual to stand on. Re-observe from Tier 1.
3	You started at Part 6 or Part 8	Reporting and parent communication feel most urgent and are furthest downstream. Go back to Part 1.
4	You broke your own standard once, publicly	Every coach recalculated instantly and correctly. Name it as an exception, name its end date, write it down — retroactively if you have to.
5	Open not-yets nobody closed	An open not-yet past its date tells the coach the record is theater. Close every one this week or stop opening them.
6	Logging quietly stopped	Type C silent drift. The floor looks fine and the reporting layer is dying. Treat the deadline as the standard and re-certify the data lines.
7	You corrected a systemic drift as individual	Three coaches off the same standard means the standard is wrong. Correcting them costs you good staff and doesn't fix it.
8	Breaches absorbed instead of split	Somebody at the door said yes to one more athlete, twelve times. Resolve every breach before optimizing anything else.
9	The makeup policy has exceptions	One family got a different answer for asking. Now it's a negotiation. Republish the policy and hold it, including for the family who's asked before.
10	Noise sold as progress	A 0.4% change reported as improvement. The first time a parent notices, every number you ever show them is discounted. Set bands and use the word <i>held</i> .
11	Only one certifier	Every hire, every advance, every sign-off routes through you. You installed a system and kept the bottleneck. Build the second Tier 3.

THE TEST, FOURTEEN WEEKS FROM NOW

Walk out on a Friday. Don't answer your phone. On Monday, ask one question: **did anything change on the floor?**

If the answer is no, you built a system. If the answer is yes, you built a document and you're still the program. The whole book is one long attempt to get you to a no.



The problem was never **effort.**

You have good coaches, real athletes, and a growing facility — and it still runs on your memory instead of a system.

A program is what one coach runs. A system is what every coach runs the same way. Everything in this book exists to move you from the first to the second, one documented standard at a time.

Work the pages. Post what's meant to be posted. Observe instead of assuming. Re-run the baseline at ninety days and read the honest number.

STRENGTH THROUGH SYSTEMS · GARRETT PHELPS, MS, CSCS

Turn Chaos into Clarity. Systems Drive Success.